

Algebraic Structure of Quantum Controlled States and Operators

Edwin Agnew

Department of Computer Science
University of Oxford

Lia Yeh

Department of Computer Science and Technology
University of Cambridge
ly404@cam.ac.uk

Richie Yeung

Department of Computer Science
University of Oxford
richie.yeung@cs.ox.ac.uk

Quantum control is an important logical primitive of quantum computing programs, and an important concept for equational reasoning in quantum graphical calculi. We show that controlled diagrams in the ZXW-calculus admit rich algebraic structure. The perspective of the higher-order map Ctrl recovers the standard notion of quantum controlled gates, while respecting sequential and parallel composition and multiple-control.

In this work, we prove that controlled square matrices form a ring and therefore satisfy powerful rewrite rules. We also show that controlled states form a ring isomorphic to multilinear polynomials. Putting these together, we have completeness for polynomials over same-size square matrices. These properties supply new rewrite rules that make factorisation of arbitrary qubit Hamiltonians achievable inside a single graphical calculus.

1 Introduction

Controlling or branching to different possible linear maps, relations, or channels is important across quantum information and quantum computation, and has been studied through many different approaches. In quantum algorithms common techniques are block encodings [17, 27] and linear combination of unitaries [7], while a number of formalisations have included routed quantum circuits [35], the many-worlds calculus [6], categorifying signal flow diagrams [3], and classical and quantum control in quantum modal logic [30].

The question we are interested in is how quantum graphical calculi such as the ZX [9], ZW [10], and ZH [2] calculus can be augmented to support properties of quantum control. An early use of controlled state diagrams was for proving constructive and rational angle ZX calculus completeness [21]. More recently, controlled state and controlled matrix diagrams have been applied to addition and differentiation of ZX diagrams [20], differentiating and integrating ZX diagrams for quantum machine learning [37], Hamiltonian exponentiation and simulation [31], non-linear optical quantum computing [13], and fermion-to-qubit mappings [23]. To sum ZX diagrams, these works have used controlled states along with the W generator from the ZW calculus.

Given how useful controlled diagrams are, a natural question to ask is why they work: What their underlying mathematical structures are, and which equational rewrites they satisfy. Before descending into the details, we present the relationship between controlled matrices, and the conventional notion of quantum controlled gates. We show how to recover the latter from the former, through the higher-order map Ctrl that maps square matrices to controlled square matrices.

First of our main results, we show that the set of all controlled n -partite states defines a commutative ring. We introduce $\boxplus$ which defines an Abelian group and $\boxtimes$ which defines a commutative monoid, and show that $\boxtimes$ distributes over $\boxplus$. The fragment of the qubit ZW calculus corresponding to controlled states, which we call *arithmetic diagrams* hence defines a commutative ring which we prove is isomorphic to multilinear polynomials $\mathbb{C}[x_1, \dots, x_n]/(x_1^2, \dots, x_n^2)$. We prove completeness for all operations in this ring by an algorithm to rewrite any arithmetic diagram to what we call *polynomial form (PNF)*. Likewise, we show that the set of all controlled square matrices on n qubits defines a non-commutative ring $(\tilde{M}^n, \triangleleft, \circ)$, and we prove a second completeness result for this ring.

To the qubit ZXW-calculus, whose completeness for arbitrary finite dimension was proven in Ref. [26], we add controlled states and controlled square matrices as new generators, along with the rewrite rules for completeness

over their rings. Now in the same calculus, we plug controlled states into each control wire of controlled square matrices, and show using only the rewrite rules so far that this is isomorphic to multivariate polynomials over same-size square matrices. Commutativity of controlled square matrices holds in the special case that the controls target mutually exclusive sectors, allowing copying of arbitrary controlled diagrams. As a result, we can factor multivariate polynomials over same-size square matrices. This third completeness result means we now have the ability to factor any Hamiltonian in the ZXW-calculus [31], even with all its terms black-boxed. In sum, these algebraic properties of quantum control give rise to powerful new graphical reasoning capabilities.

2 The ZXW-Calculus

This section introduces the qubit case of the ZXW-calculus, a graphical formalism for qudit computation which unified the ZX and ZW calculi and synthesised their relative strengths [26]. The ZXW-calculus consists of diagrams built from a small number of generators and equipped with a complete set of rewrite rules, which enables all equalities between linear maps to be proven diagrammatically. In this work, diagrams are read top to bottom and left to right.

The qubit ZXW-calculus is built from the following generators:

$$\left[\begin{array}{|} \hline | \\ \hline \end{array} \right] = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \quad \left[\begin{array}{c} \diagup \quad \diagdown \\ \diagdown \quad \diagup \end{array} \right] = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \quad \left[\begin{array}{c} \curvearrowright \\ \hline \end{array} \right] = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \quad \left[\begin{array}{c} \cup \\ \hline \end{array} \right] = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \quad (2.1)$$

$$\left[\begin{array}{c} n \\ \vdots \\ \text{green box } c \\ \vdots \\ m \end{array} \right] = |0^m\rangle\langle 0^n| + c|1^m\rangle\langle 1^n|, c \in \mathbb{C} \quad \left[\begin{array}{c} \blacktriangle \\ \hline \end{array} \right] = |00\rangle\langle 0| + |01\rangle\langle 1| + |10\rangle\langle 1| \quad (2.2)$$

$$\left[\begin{array}{c} \text{yellow box} \\ \hline \end{array} \right] = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \quad (2.3)$$

For simplicity, we introduce the following additional notation:

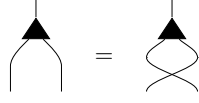
$$\begin{array}{c} \dots \\ \diagdown \quad \diagup \\ \text{green box } \alpha \\ \diagup \quad \diagdown \\ \dots \end{array} := \begin{array}{c} \dots \\ \diagdown \quad \diagup \\ \text{green box } e^{i\alpha} \\ \diagup \quad \diagdown \\ \dots \end{array} \quad \begin{array}{c} \dots \\ \diagdown \quad \diagup \\ \text{green box } 0 \\ \diagup \quad \diagdown \\ \dots \end{array} := \begin{array}{c} \dots \\ \diagdown \quad \diagup \\ \text{green box } 1 \\ \diagup \quad \diagdown \\ \dots \end{array} \quad \begin{array}{c} \dots \\ \diagdown \quad \diagup \\ \text{red box } \alpha \\ \diagup \quad \diagdown \\ \dots \end{array} := \begin{array}{c} \dots \\ \diagdown \quad \diagup \\ \text{green box } u_{m,n} \\ \text{green box } \alpha \\ \diagup \quad \diagdown \\ \dots \end{array} \quad (2.4)$$

$$\begin{array}{c} \dots \\ \diagdown \quad \diagup \\ \blacktriangle \\ \diagup \quad \diagdown \\ \dots \end{array} := \begin{array}{c} \dots \\ \diagdown \quad \diagup \\ \blacktriangle \\ \diagup \quad \diagdown \\ \dots \end{array} \quad \begin{array}{c} \dots \\ \diagdown \quad \diagup \\ \blacktriangledown \\ \diagup \quad \diagdown \\ \dots \end{array} := \begin{array}{c} \dots \\ \diagdown \quad \diagup \\ \blacktriangle \\ \diagup \quad \diagdown \\ \dots \end{array} \quad (2.5)$$

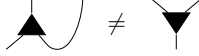
where $u_{m,n} = d^{\frac{m+n-2}{2}} - 1$, such that the green box $\text{green box } \alpha$ equals the scalar $2^{\frac{m+n-2}{2}}$.

Equations in ZXW apply diagrammatic rewrite rules which prove equalities of the underlying matrices. Omitted from Figure 1 are the *structural rules* ubiquitous to quantum graphical calculi, such as that swapping twice yields the two-qubit identity and that an S-shaped cup and cap pair yields the one-qubit identity. These collectively are referred to as the *Only Connectivity Matters* rule, which governs that in this calculus the following operations preserve semantic equality: So long as all connections are preserved between all inputs, outputs, and generators of the diagram, the spatial position and orientation of each generator can be varied, and wires are free to cross or bend.

The Z and X generators are symmetric with respect to swapping two inputs, while the Z, X, and W generators are symmetric with respect to swapping two outputs:


(Sym)

However, unlike the Z and X generators, the W generator is not symmetric with respect to swapping an input and an output due to the following:


(Asym)

For this reason, care must be taken that exactly one wire of each W generator is unambiguously its exactly one input, drawn aligned with one point of the triangle.

The complete rule set of the qubit ZXW-calculus from Ref. [26], and our new rules for controlled states and controlled square matrices, are presented in Figure 1. Several important lemmas are found in Appendix B.

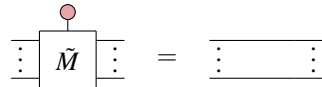
Remark 1. We work with the complete qubit ZXW-calculus in this work in order to connect usage of these results to the qubit ZX-calculus, such as the CX gate in Equation (4.3) and Hamiltonian operators explored in [31]. However, the proofs of completeness for arithmetic diagrams of this work use a subset of the qubit ZXW-calculus rules which also follow from the minimal ZW-calculus of [14], which were established after the main results of this work were found [1]. In the proof of Theorem 6.1, the only place we used (TA) was in the proof of Lemma 6.1. We could have equivalently replaced Equation (TA) with the equation of Lemma 6.1; and substituted the one-input, zero-output X spider with the one-input, zero-output W node as done in [14].

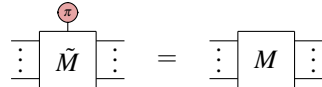
3 Controlled Diagrams

Following [31], we cover the definitions of controlled states and controlled square matrices, and arithmetic on them. Note that this is a different definition of controlled states to Ref. [20] in which controlling on $|0\rangle$ gives $|+\rangle^{\otimes n}$ instead of $|0\rangle^{\otimes n}$; this choice appears to make a substantial difference in the algebraic properties, which we discuss in Remark 4.

We define as a higher-order generator the controlled square matrix $\tilde{M}$, whose interpretation is entirely determined by the square matrix M by which it is labelled. In the next section, we show how this definition relates to the higher-order map Ctrl that sends any square matrix M to its controlled square matrix $\tilde{M}$.

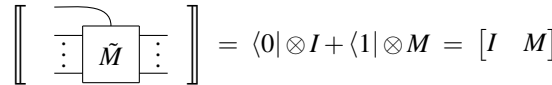
Definition 3.1. Any diagram satisfying both axioms below is called a *controlled square matrix* of the labelled square matrix M . We denote any such controlled diagram by $\tilde{M}$.


(CM0)


(CM1)

Remark 2. This definition can be applied irrespective of the dimensions of M so long as it is a square matrix. If working with only qubits then it is convenient to restrict to M being a $2^n \times 2^n$ matrix for some $n \in \mathbb{N}$, but this is not necessary for the definition of controlled square matrices.

We represent the additional dimension of $\tilde{M}$ as a vertical wire to distinguish it as the control wire. Interpreting this control wire as an input, because the interpretations of the generators of the ZXW-calculus from the previous section fix that $\begin{bmatrix} \text{red circle} \\ | \end{bmatrix} = |0\rangle$ and $\begin{bmatrix} \text{red circle} \\ | \end{bmatrix} = |1\rangle$, the interpretation of any controlled square matrix $\tilde{M}$ is necessarily the linear map:


(3.1)

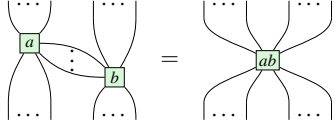
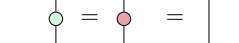
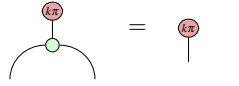
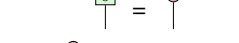
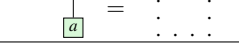
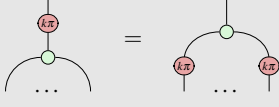
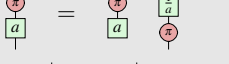
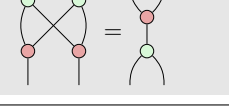
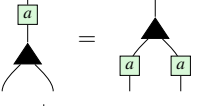
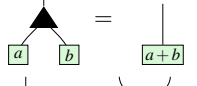
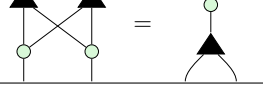
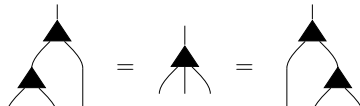
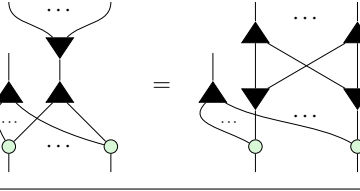
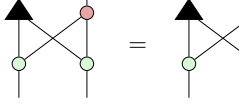
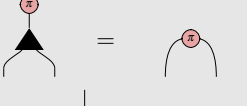
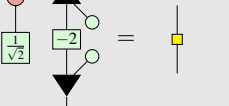
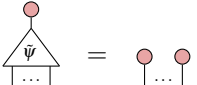
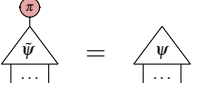
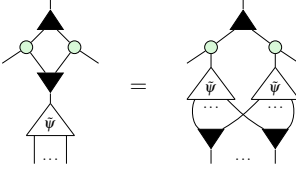
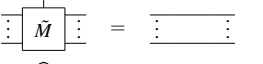
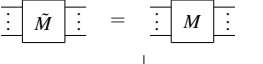
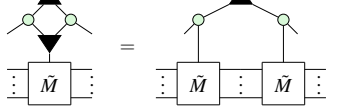
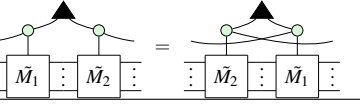
ZX Rules	
	(S1)
	(S2)
	(K0)
	(Zer)
	(Ept)
	(K1)
	(K2)
	(H)
	(B2)
ZW Rules	
	(Pcpy)
	(Add)
	(BZW)
	(Aso)
	(WW)
ZXW Rules	
	(Bs0)
	(TA)
	(Bs1)
	(HD)
Controlled Ring Rules	
	(CS0)
	(CS1)
	(CScpy)
	(CM0)
	(CM1)
	(CMcpy)
	(CMcom)

Figure 1: These ZX, ZW, and ZXW Rules are altogether complete for qubit linear maps, where $k \in \{0, 1\}$ and $a \in \mathbb{C}$; we give their derivation from the restriction of the complete ZXW-calculus axioms for arbitrary finite dimension [26] to the qubit setting in Appendix C. Through Theorem 6.1 of this work, we show that the above ZX, ZW, and ZXW Axioms with white background, form a complete set of axioms for *arithmetic diagrams* (Definition 6.1). Adding to these the CScpy, CMcpy, and CMcom axioms, we can show that controlled states and controlled operators form rings, culminating in Theorem 7.1 achieving completeness and minimality for all operations over these rings.

Similarly, we can define higher-order controlled states as generators.

Definition 3.2. Any diagram satisfying both axioms below is called a *controlled state* of the labelled n -qubit state M . We denote any such controlled diagram by $\tilde{M}$.

$$\begin{array}{c} \text{red circle} \\ \triangleup \\ \psi \\ \vdots \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \text{red circle} \quad \text{red circle} \\ \vdots \quad \vdots \end{array} \quad (\text{CS0})$$

$$\begin{array}{c} \text{red circle} \\ \triangleup \\ \psi \\ \vdots \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \triangleup \\ \psi \\ \vdots \end{array} \quad (\text{CS1})$$

Again, the interpretation of any controlled state as a linear map is entirely determined by the statevector of its labelled state ψ :

$$\left[\begin{array}{c} \triangleup \\ \psi \\ \vdots \end{array} \right] = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ \psi \\ 0 \\ \vdots \end{bmatrix} \quad (3.2)$$

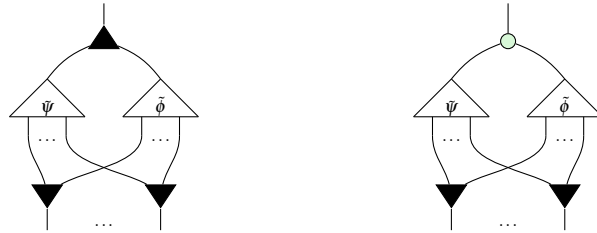
Definition 3.3. Given controlled matrices $\tilde{M}_1, \dots, \tilde{M}_k$ and $c_1, \dots, c_k \in \mathbb{C}$, the controlled square matrices $\widetilde{\Pi_i M_i}$ and $\widetilde{\Sigma_i c_i M_i}$ are defined as follows:



Proposition 1 (Propositions 3.3 and 3.4 of [31]). The above diagrams are indeed the controlled diagrams for $\Pi_i M_i$ and $\Sigma_i c_i M_i$, respectively.

The addition and multiplication of controlled states are defined similarly to controlled matrix arithmetic, except that a layer of $\blacktriangledown$ s are appended at the bottom to preserve the number of outputs. The role of $\blacktriangledown$ is to *copy* controlled diagrams, as we will show in Section 5.

Definition 3.4. Given controlled states $\tilde{\psi}$ and $\tilde{\phi}$, we define addition $\tilde{\psi} \boxplus \tilde{\phi}$ and multiplication $\tilde{\psi} \boxtimes \tilde{\phi}$ operations on them to result in the controlled states:



Remark 3. Ref. [31] defined this addition with red spiders at the bottom instead of $\blacktriangledown$ s; the linear map is the same, being $\widetilde{\phi + \psi}$. In choosing to use $\blacktriangledown$, we will soon define the arithmetic fragment of the ZW-calculus.

Removing the $\blacktriangledown$'s from the bottom of this multiplication gives the controlled diagram for the tensor product in Hilbert space $\widetilde{\psi \otimes \phi}$, as noted in Ref. [20].

Although the interpretation of $\tilde{\psi} \boxtimes \tilde{\phi}$ is not the controlled multiplication of the linear maps ψ and ϕ , nor as nice an expression in terms of ψ and ϕ , we will show in this work that this is in fact multiplication in the ring of *multilinear polynomials*.

4 Quantum Control as a Higher-Order Map

In quantum circuits, quantum control is realised through controlled gates. In this section, we illustrate the correspondence between the controlled diagrams investigated in this work and the conventional concept of controlled gates in quantum circuits. Specifically, we can derive the latter as a special case of the former. We show this by reasoning with controlled gates through a straightforward construction on top of our ring of controlled square matrices. We define the higher-order map Ctrl which takes a square matrix $M : V \rightarrow V$ to its controlled square diagram $V \otimes \mathbb{C}^2 \rightarrow V \otimes \mathbb{C}^2$. In the functorial box notation of [24], we write

$$\begin{array}{c} \mathbb{C}^2 \\ \hline V \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \text{Ctrl} \\ \hline M \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \mathbb{C}^2 \\ \hline V \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \mathbb{C}^2 \\ \hline V \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \text{Ctrl} \\ \hline \tilde{M} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \mathbb{C}^2 \\ \hline V \end{array} \quad (4.1)$$

where

$$\left[\begin{array}{c} \text{Ctrl} \\ \hline \tilde{M} \end{array} \right] = \begin{bmatrix} I & 0 \\ 0 & M \end{bmatrix} \quad (4.2)$$

Detailed exploration of control as a functor, extending props to controlled props, was independently carried out by Delorme and Perdrix in [15].

For example, the qubit CNOT gate precisely matches its definition of a controlled X gate because:

$$\begin{array}{c} \text{Ctrl} \\ \hline X \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \text{Ctrl} \\ \hline \tilde{X} \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \text{Ctrl} \\ \hline \text{CNOT} \end{array} \quad (4.3)$$

We prove in Appendix A that composition of controlled operations in sequence and in parallel is well-behaved.

Proposition 2.

$$\begin{array}{c} \text{Ctrl} \\ \hline M_1 \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \text{Ctrl} \\ \hline M_2 \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \text{Ctrl} \\ \hline M_1 M_2 \end{array} \quad (4.4)$$

Proposition 3.

$$\begin{array}{c} \text{Ctrl} \\ \hline M_1 \\ \hline M_2 \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \text{Ctrl} \\ \hline M_1 \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \text{Ctrl} \\ \hline M_2 \end{array} \quad (4.5)$$

Furthermore, successive applications of Ctrl recovers the standard notion of multiple-control, which computes the AND of the control qubits:

Proposition 4.

Diagram (4.6) shows the equivalence between two representations of a controlled operation. On the left, a matrix $\tilde{M}$ is controlled by two $\mathbb{C}^2$ qubits (green circles) and a V qubit. On the right, the same operation is represented as a nested box structure. The outer box is controlled by two $\mathbb{C}^2$ qubits and contains a V qubit and a Ctrl block. Inside this is another box controlled by a $\mathbb{C}^2$ qubit, containing a V qubit and a Ctrl block. The innermost box contains the matrix M . The equation is labeled (4.6).

5 Ring Axioms for Controlled Diagrams

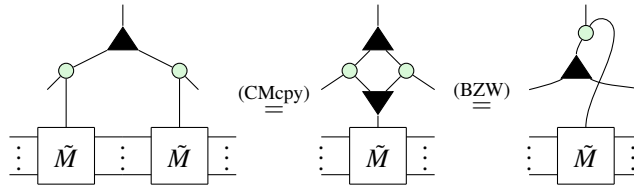
In this section, we reverse-engineer the underlying algebraic properties of controlled state and controlled square matrix diagrams. This builds up to diagrams for the unique normal form for states used for the first proofs of complete axiomatisation for qubit graphical calculi [18, 19]. All proofs in this section can be found in Appendix D.2.

There are only five Controlled Ring Rules necessary to derive the new completeness results in this work, presented in Figure 1. All other diagrammatic equalities in this paper were proven using only the rules in Figure 1. We verify the soundness of the rules for controlled diagrams in Appendix D.1 by plugging in basis states.

5.1 Controlled Matrices

Let $\tilde{M}_n$ be the set of controlled square matrices on n qubits. The goal of this section is to prove that the addition and multiplication operations introduced above induce a ring on $\tilde{M}_n$. By Proposition 1, the addition and multiplication of controlled matrices is just the controlled addition and multiplication of the underlying matrices so the fact that the ring properties hold is not particularly surprising. What is more interesting is how easily these properties can be proven with a small subset of the ZXW rules. Likewise, we show that the set of controlled n -qubit states $\tilde{S}_n$ also forms a ring. The first rule enables us to copy controlled matrices.

For any square matrix M ,



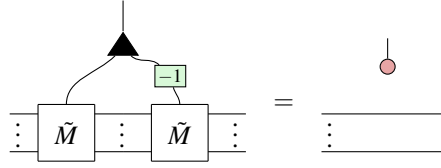
Now we show that controlled matrix addition and multiplication satisfy the ring axioms. Associativity of $+$, $\times$ follow immediately from (Aso, S1), respectively. Commutativity of addition is just (CMcom). If $M_1 \circ M_2 \neq M_2 \circ M_1$, then the controlled matrices will of course not commute either, so we cannot expect commutativity of multiplication in general. The remaining ring properties are as follows:

Lemma 5.1. *The additive identity is defined as $\text{red circle} \otimes I_n$:*

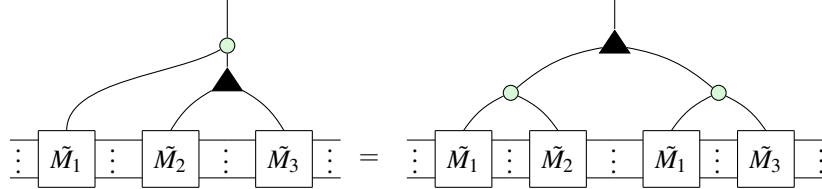
Diagrammatic equation (5.1) defines the additive identity. It shows a matrix $\tilde{M}_1$ with a control qubit (green circle) and a target qubit (black triangle). The control qubit is connected to a red circle, which represents the additive identity. The equation is labeled (5.1).

The multiplicative identity is defined very similarly as $\text{green circle} \otimes I_n$. The existence of additive inverses relies on the copying lemma from before.

Lemma 5.2. The additive inverse of $\tilde{M}$ is built from $\begin{array}{c} \text{---} \\ | \\ \boxed{-1} \\ | \\ \text{---} \end{array}$:



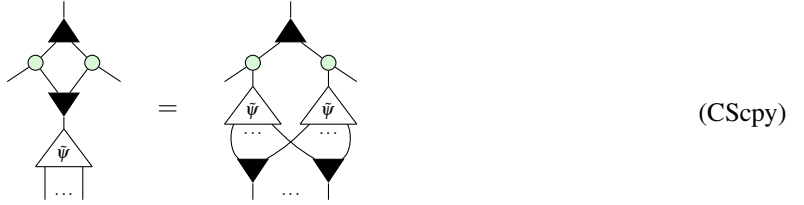
Lemma 5.3. The addition and multiplication operations of controlled matrices distribute:



Combining the lemmas of this section shows that controlled matrices form a non-commutative ring.

5.2 Controlled States

A similar result can be shown for controlled states, this time forming a commutative ring. Once again, we start with the ability to copy controlled states: for any state ψ ,



Then the remaining ring properties can be shown using diagrammatic rewrites.

Lemma 5.4. For n -partite states ψ_1, ψ_2 , $\tilde{\psi}_1 \boxplus \tilde{\psi}_2 = \tilde{\psi}_2 \boxplus \tilde{\psi}_1$.

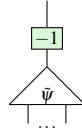
Lemma 5.5. For n -partite states ψ_1, ψ_2, ψ_3 , $(\tilde{\psi}_1 \boxplus \tilde{\psi}_2) \boxplus \tilde{\psi}_3 = \tilde{\psi}_1 \boxplus (\tilde{\psi}_2 \boxplus \tilde{\psi}_3)$.

Next we have the additive identity.

Lemma 5.6. $\tilde{\psi} \boxplus \tilde{0} = \tilde{\psi}$.

The additive inverse is defined similarly to the case of controlled matrices.

Lemma 5.7. For a controlled state $\tilde{\psi}$, its additive inverse $\tilde{\psi}^{-1}$ is given by:



Lemma 5.8. For a controlled states $\tilde{\psi}_1, \tilde{\psi}_2, \tilde{\psi}_3$, $(\tilde{\psi}_1 \boxtimes \tilde{\psi}_2) \boxtimes \tilde{\psi}_3 = \tilde{\psi}_1 \boxtimes (\tilde{\psi}_2 \boxtimes \tilde{\psi}_3)$.

Unlike for controlled matrices, we have also commutativity of addition.

Lemma 5.9. For controlled states $\tilde{\psi}_1, \tilde{\psi}_2$, $\tilde{\psi}_1 \boxtimes \tilde{\psi}_2 = \tilde{\psi}_2 \boxtimes \tilde{\psi}_1$.

Finally, we must prove distributivity.

Lemma 5.10. $\tilde{\psi}_1 \boxtimes (\tilde{\psi}_2 \boxplus \tilde{\psi}_3) = (\tilde{\psi}_1 \boxtimes \tilde{\psi}_2) \boxplus (\tilde{\psi}_1 \boxtimes \tilde{\psi}_3)$.

Remark 4. A different addition and multiplication for controlled states was defined in Ref. [21]. The definitions there corresponded to entry-wise addition and multiplication of statevectors, while our $\boxplus$ and $\boxtimes$ correspond to addition and multiplication of polynomials, which we show next.

6 Isomorphism between the Ring of Controlled States and Multilinear Polynomials

It's been known since 2011 that  and  can be used to add and multiply number states $|a\rangle$, respectively [11]. In the previous section we saw that  and  can moreover be used to copy controlled diagrams. In this section, we explain this connection by demonstrating that controlled states are in fact isomorphic to multilinear polynomials. This being a bijection is a well-known folklore result in the study of entangled states, but to the best of our inquiries we are not aware of a proof. More generally, Ref. [39] presented Cartesian Distributive Categories exemplified by polynomial circuits, which are isomorphic to polynomials over arbitrary commutative semirings or rings; their proof is non-constructive, giving explicit proof only for the case of Boolean circuits [38]. Our proof hinges on a normal form inspired by the recent proof of completeness for the ZXW calculus [26], suggesting that much of the expressive power of the ZXW calculus comes from this algebraic structure.

Firstly, we describe how to interpret certain ZXW diagrams as polynomials. Consider the diagrams:

$$\begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram 1: A black triangle pointing up with a green box containing -1 below it.} \\ \text{Diagram 2: A black triangle pointing up with two green boxes containing 2 and 3 below it.} \end{array} \quad (6.1)$$

If we treat the bottom wires as an indeterminate x , we can read these bottom-up as computing $x - 1$ and $2x + 3$, respectively. Moreover, since these diagrams are both controlled states, they can be added together, yielding a diagram resembling $3x + 2$:

$$\begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram 1} \\ \text{Diagram 2} \end{array} \stackrel{(Aso)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram 3: A black triangle pointing up with two green boxes containing 1 and 2 below it.} \\ \text{Diagram 4: A black triangle pointing up with two green boxes containing -1 and 3 below it.} \end{array} \stackrel{(B.3)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram 5: A black triangle pointing up with a green box containing 3 below it, and a green box containing 2 to its right.} \\ x \end{array} \quad (6.2)$$

When trying to multiply these diagrams, rather than getting $(x - 1)(2x + 3) = 2x^2 + x - 3$, we instead get $x - 3$.

$$\begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram 1} \\ \text{Diagram 2} \end{array} \stackrel{(B.6)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram 3: A complex diagram with multiple green circles and black triangles.} \\ \text{Diagram 4: A complex diagram with multiple green circles and black triangles.} \end{array} \stackrel{(Pcpr)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram 5: A complex diagram with multiple green circles and black triangles.} \\ \text{Diagram 6: A complex diagram with multiple green circles and black triangles.} \end{array} \stackrel{(B.7)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram 7: A complex diagram with multiple green circles and black triangles.} \\ \text{Diagram 8: A complex diagram with multiple green circles and black triangles.} \end{array} \stackrel{(6.4)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram 9: A complex diagram with multiple green circles and black triangles.} \\ \text{Diagram 10: A complex diagram with multiple green circles and black triangles.} \end{array} \stackrel{(B.3)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram 11: A black triangle pointing up with a green box containing -3 below it, and a green box containing 1 to its right.} \\ \text{Diagram 12: A black triangle pointing up with a green box containing -3 below it, and a green box containing 1 to its right.} \end{array} \stackrel{(B.3)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram 13: A black triangle pointing up with a green box containing -3 below it, and a green box containing 1 to its right.} \\ x \end{array} \quad (6.3)$$

The reason for the missing $2x^2$ term is due to the following:

Lemma 6.1.

$$(6.4)$$

This lemma, proven in Appendix B, implies that $x^2 = 0$ for all variables x . Other than this, controlled state arithmetic appears to faithfully reflect polynomial arithmetic. To formalise this correspondence, we introduce the following definition.

Definition 6.1. A ZXW diagram with a single input on top is **arithmetic** if it contains only $|$, $\times$ wires, $\blacktriangle$, $\circ$, $\blacktriangledown$ nodes and $\boxed{a}$ boxes.

Remark 5. This fragment of the ZXW-calculus defines a subcategory; adding $\circ$, this is an instance of a Cartesian Distributive Category as defined in Ref. [39].

To interpret an arithmetic ZXW diagram as an arithmetic expression, read $\blacktriangle$ as $+$, $\circ$ as $\times$, $\boxed{a}$ as the number a , $\blacktriangledown$ as fanout and output/bottom wires as variables $x_1, \dots, x_n$ numbered from left to right. The following lemma establishes that all arithmetic diagrams are controlled states:

Lemma 6.2. For any arithmetic diagram A ,

$$(6.5)$$

Proof. By definition, other than wires A contains only $\blacktriangle$, $\circ$, $\blacktriangledown$, and $\boxed{a}$. This lemma holds when the arithmetic diagram consists of $\blacktriangle$, $\circ$, and $\blacktriangledown$, as a result of these generators recursively copying $\circ$ due to (Bs0, K0, B.1) respectively. Then considering arithmetic diagrams which also contain $\boxed{a}$, as the other three generators copy $\circ$, the lemma continues to hold through application of the axiom (Ept). $\square$

Just as it is typical to represent a polynomial in normal form as a sum of products, it is possible to rewrite every arithmetic diagram into a normal form as a single $\blacktriangle$, followed by a layer of $\circ$, followed by a layer of $\boxed{a}$, $\blacktriangledown$.

Definition 6.2. An n -output arithmetic diagram is said to be written in **polynormal form** (PNF) if it is of the form:

$$(6.6)$$

The i th coefficient a_i is connected to the k th $\blacktriangledown$ iff the k th bit in the binary expansion of i is 1.

This normal form is familiar from completeness of all linear maps for qubits [19] and for qudits [26]. The reason we introduce the definition of a PNF is that it is an arithmetic diagram and therefore has a more immediate arithmetic interpretation. The reason for the specific connectivity condition is that it enables a diagram in PNF to directly represent its own matrix.

Proposition 5. The diagram in Equation (6.6) equals the matrix
$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & a_0 \\ 0 & a_1 \\ \vdots & \vdots \\ 0 & a_{2^n-1} \end{bmatrix}.$$

Proof. See Appendix E. □

Thus, every controlled state can be represented as at least one arithmetic diagram (namely, its PNF). Moreover, we now show that any other arithmetic diagram can always be rewritten to its PNF.

Theorem 6.1. All arithmetic diagrams can be rewritten into PNF through application of ZXW-calculus rules. Therefore, the rules applied suffice for completeness for the arithmetic fragment of the ZXW-calculus.

Proof. We present an algorithm to rewrite any arithmetic diagram to PNF in Appendix E. As with [26], this is sufficient for completeness since equality of diagrams reduces to writing both diagrams in PNF and then reversing one of the directions. □

Remark 6. All of the qubit ZXW-calculus rules [26] applied in this proof are derivable from the minimal qubit ZW-calculus rules from [14], derived independently from this work [1]. We can replace the TA rule with the rule of Lemma 6.1, and the qubit ZXW-calculus WW rule is derived in their [14, Lemma 23].

6.1 Isomorphism

At last we can prove the isomorphism. Recall that $\tilde{S}_n$ is the ring of controlled states with n outputs. Throughout, we shall let $\mathcal{P}_n$ denote the multilinear ring $\mathbb{C}[x_1, \dots, x_n]/(x_1^2, \dots, x_n^2)$.

Theorem 6.2. There is an isomorphism $\mathcal{P}_n \simeq \tilde{S}_n$.

First, we define the map $\phi_n : \mathcal{P}_n \rightarrow \tilde{S}_n$ before proving it induces an isomorphism. ϕ_n is defined to map an arbitrary polynomial $p(x_1, \dots, x_n) = a_0 + a_1 x_n + \dots + a_{2^n-1} x_1 x_2 \dots x_n$ to the PNF in equation (6.6).

Some important special cases are mapping scalars $a \in \mathbb{C}$ and indeterminates x_i :

$$\phi_n(a) = \begin{array}{c} \boxed{a} \\ | \\ \text{diagram with } n \text{ red dots and } n \text{ vertical lines} \end{array} \quad \phi_n(x_1) = \begin{array}{c} \text{diagram with } n \text{ red dots and } n \text{ vertical lines, } x_1 \text{ control} \\ \text{diagram with } n \text{ red dots and } n \text{ vertical lines} \end{array}, \phi_n(x_2) = \begin{array}{c} \text{diagram with } n \text{ red dots and } n \text{ vertical lines, } x_2 \text{ control} \\ \text{diagram with } n \text{ red dots and } n \text{ vertical lines} \end{array}, \dots, \phi_n(x_n) = \begin{array}{c} \text{diagram with } n \text{ red dots and } n \text{ vertical lines, } x_n \text{ control} \\ \text{diagram with } n \text{ red dots and } n \text{ vertical lines} \end{array} \quad (6.7)$$

The proof that ϕ_n is a homomorphism resembles equations (6.2) and (6.3), but with greater generality. That ϕ_n is a bijection relies on Proposition 5. The full proof is found in Appendix E.

7 Completeness for Factoring Controlled Operators

Our results so far show that controlled states and controlled square matrices each induce a ring structure, as they satisfy all ring axioms. Furthermore, the ring of controlled states is isomorphic to the ring of multilinear polynomials over complex numbers. The question then arises: What is the ring of controlled square matrices isomorphic to?

In this section, we will show that the ring of controlled square matrices is isomorphic to the ring of multivariate polynomials over same-size square matrices over the complex numbers, with complex number coefficients. Therefore, the former admits a completeness result over the latter.

In the previous section, the indeterminates of the multilinear polynomials were complex numbers represented by $\boxed{a}$'s. Consider them to instead be same-size matrices represented by controlled square matrix diagrams. We then have that:

Theorem 7.1. *Consider a multivariate polynomial of the form $P = \sum_{i=1}^{m_i} c_i \Pi_{j=0}^{m_{ij}} M_{ij}$ over same-size square matrices $M_{ij} \in \mathbb{C}^{n \times n}$, where $n \in \mathbb{N}$, all $c_i \in \mathbb{C}$, and all $m_i, m_{ij} \geq 0$. Then, the controlled operator $\tilde{P} = \sum_{i=1}^{m_i} c_i \Pi_{j=0}^{m_{ij}} \tilde{M}_{ij}$ is uniquely represented by a ZXW diagram in normal form, consisting of ZXW diagrams for each $\tilde{M}_{ij}$ corresponding to M_{ij} composed according to the ring axioms of controlled square matrices.*

Proof. The proof is by deriving a unique normal form, having fixed an (arbitrary) order on the same-size square matrix variables. The algorithm to arrive at this normal form starts by rewriting the diagram sans the controlled

square matrices to PNF, by the procedure of Theorem 6.1. Next, remove all $\blacktriangledown$'s by using (CMcpy) to make copies of the controlled square matrices. Finally, use (CMcom) to commute controlled square matrices whose controls act on mutually exclusive sectors past each other. The algorithm terminates with the controlled square matrix terms ordered by their mutually exclusive sectors in lexicographical order with respect to the order of their variables.

To show minimality, we can consider that the CMcpy and CMcom rules are the only rules here that involve the controlled square matrix generator, and so they cannot be derivable from the other rules here. The CMcpy rule can change the total number of controlled square matrices in the diagram, while the CMcom rule cannot. On the other hand, the CMcom rule can apply to two different controlled square matrices, changing their order where the outputs of one are inputs to the other; the CMcpy rule applies to two controlled square matrices only if they are of the same matrix.

The rules used here to derive this completeness result are the same subset of ZXW rules used for completeness for arithmetic diagrams in the ZXW-calculus in Theorem 6.1, plus the CMcpy and CMcom rules. When using the minimal set of rules from [14] for completeness for arithmetic diagrams, adding the CMcpy and CMcom rules is also a minimal rule set, i.e. none of the rules are derivable from the others. $\square$

Remark 7. These procedures guarantee that controlled operators in mutually exclusive sectors are commutable past each other. This guarantee does not apply to controlled operators in the same sector, as this would require additional information about the operators themselves beyond being controlled operators.

7.1 Factorising Hamiltonians

An application of Theorem 7.1 is that we can leverage our complete rules for arithmetic ZW diagrams and controlled diagrams to perform the equivalent ring operations to those on the corresponding multivariate polynomials. This is important for synthesising quantum circuits for a number of quantum algorithms whose constructions involve many controlled gates. These techniques are particularly amenable for quantum circuits derived from Hamiltonian operators, as is ubiquitous in quantum algorithms for quantum chemistry and condensed matter physics.

The earliest works on diagrammatic presentations of Hamiltonian operators include the Schrödinger equation, Taylor expansion, and Trotterization [31]; and diagrammatical differentiation and integration of parametrised quantum circuits applicable to analysing barren plateaus [37]. For Hamiltonians fully instantiated in terms of the ZX- or ZXW-calculus generators, including arbitrary qubit Hamiltonians that are expressible as linear combinations of tensor products of Pauli operators, the completeness results of these graphical calculi guarantee that any possible factorisations are derivable from the rules of the calculus.

However, while Hamiltonian operators are ultimately compiled to qubit Pauli operators if executed on qubit quantum computers, typically the physical systems of interest are not natively qubit systems. Controlled operators for non-qubit systems in quantum graphical calculi include spin-optical interactions [13], continuous-variable operators [32], fermion-to-qubit mappings [23], and SU(2) representations [36]. Ref. [23] notably used one of the new rules for controlled diagrams first proposed in this work, (CMcpy), to derive a general form for any two-body fermionic Hamiltonian in second quantisation under any linear encoding.

In this work, we introduce graphical rewrite rules that can involve and even copy black-box diagrams so long as they are controlled square matrices. To present a small working example, consider same-size square matrices

I, A, B , and $a, b, c \in \mathbb{C}$. The equivalent ring operations for the below factorisation of an example Hamiltonian are performed directly on the controlled diagram.

$$\begin{aligned}
 p(\tilde{A}, \tilde{B}) &= aI + \widetilde{bA^2} + cBA = \\
 &= \text{Diagram 1} \quad \text{(CMcom)} \quad \text{Diagram 2} \\
 &= \text{Diagram 3} \quad \text{(CMcpy)} \quad \text{Diagram 4} \quad \text{(BZW)} = aI + \widetilde{(bA + cB)A}
 \end{aligned} \tag{7.1}$$

The completeness results of the present work guarantee that for any Hamiltonian, the graphical rewrite rules of Figure 1 are capable of deriving any regroupings of the Hamiltonian terms. This may be generally of interest because factoring Hamiltonians reduces the Hamiltonian term count and therefore the circuit complexity, whereas expanding to unique polynomial form enables verifying that a given quantum computation indeed implements the desired Hamiltonian. When the control structure has the form of any arithmetic diagrams, then this guarantee holds even when no specific diagrammatic instantiation is fixed for the Hamiltonian terms, with the complexity of obtaining polynomial form moreover scaling as a function of the number of terms in the Hamiltonian. In contrast, naively applying the normal form procedure for the linear map itself scales as a function of the size of the matrix, which is exponential in the number of qubits.

8 Conclusion

To conclude, we proved completeness for all controlled n -partite states, which we showed form a commutative ring isomorphic to multilinear polynomials. Also, we showed that all controlled n -qubit square matrices form a non-commutative ring. Furthermore, we have completeness for plugging controlled states into the control wires of controlled diagrams, isomorphic to all multivariate polynomials over same-size square matrices, with application to factoring Hamiltonians. When the controls target mutually exclusive sectors, a rewrite rule can be applied to copy any controlled diagram, and thereby factor any Hamiltonian.

We have shown that every (controlled) state computes a polynomial; hence, we can interpret a universal fragment of the ZXW-calculus as corresponding to arithmetic circuits. This generalises Ref. [5], which found an algebraic interpretation of a certain fragment of ZW calculus. This line of reinterpreting quantum circuits as computing polynomials rather than unitary matrices offers a new perspective on quantum computation.

In another direction, we can apply completeness for polynomials isomorphic to controlled states to study entanglement. It can be easily shown diagrammatically that the polynomials corresponding to entangled (non-separable) states are exactly those that cannot be factored into irreducibles containing only variables corresponding to Alice's subsystem or only corresponding to Bob's subsystem. Since there are efficient algorithms for polynomial factorisation [16], this gives rise to a novel entanglement classification algorithm for pure states. Further developing this into a more refined algebraic theory of entanglement, building on the work in Ref. [1], could offer further insights.

We expect these results admit a natural extension for any controlled square matrices and controlled states in finite-dimensional Hilbert space, due to the completeness proof techniques of [26, 14, 25]. In all three of these works, while the central completeness result was for linear maps of higher- or mixed-dimensional Hilbert spaces, the normal forms themselves all involved restricting a qudit input to the W node to a qubit subspace of the qudit. Given the similarity of the ZW rules, we expect the underlying ring structures to be isomorphic even though [26, 25] and [14] differ in interpretation of the generators, where the W node of the latter is rescaled by multinomial coefficients relative to the former. Note that the completeness results of this work for controlled states do not directly follow from these completeness results for states, whose normal forms fix the control wire of the topmost W node to $|1\rangle$ instead of leaving this control wire open-ended.

As for when the control wires can take values beyond this two-dimensional subspace, we expect there to likewise be interesting underlying algebraic structure. A starting guess would be that if qudit controlled states also admitted an equivalence to multivariate polynomials, they would instead be modulo d th powers of the variables, of the form $\mathbb{C}^{d-1}[x_1, \dots, x_n]/(x_1^d, \dots, x_n^d)$, due to the Hopf law between Z and W. Qudit multiple-control would likely have more complex structure than the qubit case here, considering the constructions for all prime-dimensional d -ary classical reversible gates and W states built in Refs. [41, 29, 40].

We are broadly interested in exploring the relations between controlled diagrams, controlled quantum circuits, and Hamiltonian operators. The completeness result for controllable quantum circuits established in [15] circumvents the unboundedness issues inherent to quantum circuits defined as a prop [8], indicating that control as a higher-order operation on quantum circuits is a powerful construction for equational reasoning. In this work, we rewrite controlled diagrams to their fully expanded polynomial form, therefore establishing that equational reasoning on the quantum circuits as diagrammatical objects [31] suffices to achieve any possible factorisations of Hamiltonian operators. While the completeness of the rules means these rules suffice to derive any equalities of quantum circuits, more work can be done on how to effectively apply these rules towards the objective of synthesising more compact circuit decompositions, particularly for multiple-controlled gates and for block encodings.

Moreover, we are curious about how to embed these new semantics for quantum controlled states and matrices into a functional programming language like in Ref. [28], and to interpret our diagrams in mixed-state quantum mechanics and relate them to the operational and denotational semantics for coherent control of Ref. [4] and to the channel construction of Ref. [12]. One approach is to consider using sector-preserving channels [34] and scoped effects [22] to more generally formulate semantics of multiple-control for heterogeneous Hilbert spaces.

Yet another direction is to reconcile the interpretation of diagrammatic differentiation of our arithmetic polynomial circuits by the approach in Ref. [39], with that of quantum circuits and ZX diagrams in Refs. [33, 37, 20].

9 Acknowledgements

We thank Bob Coecke for motivating our exploration of these topics. We are grateful to all the collaboration with Matt Wilson in discovering the functorial properties of control. We thank Razin Shaikh, Hany (Quanlong) Wang, Itai Leigh, Tim Forrer, Aleks Kissinger, Frank (Peng) Fu, and Maxim van den Berg for insightful discussions. We also thank the anonymous reviewers who have given feedback on this work for their helpful comments. LY would like to thank the Google PhD Fellowship and the Basil Reeve Graduate Clarendon Scholarship at Oriel College for PhD funding at the University of Oxford, and the Tencent Post-Doctoral Research Fellowship at the University of Cambridge. RY would like to thank Simon Harrison for his generous support via the Wolfson Harrison UKRI Quantum Foundation Scholarship.

References

- [1] AGNEW, E. Quantum Polynomials in the ZXW Calculus. Master’s thesis, University of Oxford, 2023.
- [2] BACKENS, M., AND KISSINGER, A. ZH: A Complete Graphical Calculus for Quantum Computations Involving Classical Non-linearity. In *Proceedings of the 15th International Conference on Quantum Physics and Logic, Halifax, Canada, 3-7th June 2018* (2019), P. Selinger and G. Chiribella, Eds., vol. 287 of *Electronic Proceedings in Theoretical Computer Science*, Open Publishing Association, pp. 23–42.
- [3] BAEZ, J. C., AND ERBELE, J. Categories in control. *Theory and Applications of Categories* 30, 24 (2015), 836–881.
- [4] BARSSE, K., PÉCHOUX, R., AND PERDRIX, S. A quantum programming language for coherent control, 2025.
- [5] CARETTE, T., MOUTOT, E., PEREZ, T., AND VILMART, R. Compositionality of Planar Perfect Matchings: A Universal and Complete Fragment of ZW-Calculus. In *50th International Colloquium on Automata, Languages, and Programming (ICALP 2023)* (Dagstuhl, Germany, 2023), K. Etessami, U. Feige, and G. Puppis, Eds., vol. 261 of *Leibniz International Proceedings in Informatics (LIPIcs)*, Schloss Dagstuhl – Leibniz-Zentrum für Informatik, pp. 120:1–120:17.
- [6] CHARDONNET, K., DE VISME, M., VALIRON, B., AND VILMART, R. The many-worlds calculus. *Logical Methods in Computer Science Volume 21, Issue 2* (May 2025).
- [7] CHILDS, A. M., AND WIEBE, N. Hamiltonian simulation using linear combinations of unitary operations. *Quantum Info. Comput.* 12, 11–12 (nov 2012), 901–924.
- [8] CLÉMENT, A., DELORME, N., AND PERDRIX, S. Minimal equational theories for quantum circuits. In *Proceedings of the 39th Annual ACM/IEEE Symposium on Logic in Computer Science* (New York, NY, USA, 2024), LICS ’24, Association for Computing Machinery.
- [9] COECKE, B., AND DUNCAN, R. Interacting quantum observables: categorical algebra and diagrammatics. *New Journal of Physics* 13 (2011), 043016.
- [10] COECKE, B., AND KISSINGER, A. The compositional structure of multipartite quantum entanglement. In *International Colloquium on Automata, Languages, and Programming* (2010), Springer, pp. 297–308.
- [11] COECKE, B., KISSINGER, A., MERRY, A., AND ROY, S. The ghz/w-calculus contains rational arithmetic. *Electronic Proceedings in Theoretical Computer Science* 52 (Mar. 2011), 34–48.
- [12] DE FELICE, G., POÓR, B., COMFORT, C., YEH, L., KUPPER, M., CASHMAN, W., AND COECKE, B. A dataflow programming framework for linear optical distributed quantum computing. *Quantum* 10 (Jan. 2026), 1972.
- [13] DE FELICE, G., SHAIKH, R. A., POÓR, B., YEH, L., WANG, Q., AND COECKE, B. Light-matter interaction in the zxw calculus. *Electronic Proceedings in Theoretical Computer Science* 384 (Aug. 2023), 20–46.
- [14] DE VISME, M., AND VILMART, R. Minimality in Finite-Dimensional ZW-Calculi. In *33rd EACSL Annual Conference on Computer Science Logic (CSL 2025)* (Dagstuhl, Germany, 2025), J. Endrullis and S. Schmitz, Eds., vol. 326 of *Leibniz International Proceedings in Informatics (LIPIcs)*, Schloss Dagstuhl – Leibniz-Zentrum für Informatik, pp. 49:1–49:22.
- [15] DELORME, N., AND PERDRIX, S. Diagrammatic reasoning with control as a constructor, applications to quantum circuits, 2026.
- [16] FORBES, M. A., AND SHPILKA, A. Complexity theory column 88: Challenges in polynomial factorization. *ACM SIGACT News* 46, 4 (2015), 32–49.

- [17] GILYÉN, A., SU, Y., LOW, G. H., AND WIEBE, N. Quantum singular value transformation and beyond: exponential improvements for quantum matrix arithmetics. In *Proceedings of the 51st Annual ACM SIGACT Symposium on Theory of Computing* (New York, NY, USA, 2019), STOC 2019, Association for Computing Machinery, p. 193–204.
- [18] HADZIHASANOVIC, A. *The algebra of entanglement and the geometry of composition*. PhD thesis, University of Oxford, 2017.
- [19] HADZIHASANOVIC, A., NG, K. F., AND WANG, Q. Two complete axiomatisations of pure-state qubit quantum computing. In *Proceedings of the 33rd Annual ACM/IEEE Symposium on Logic in Computer Science* (New York, NY, USA, 2018), LICS '18, Association for Computing Machinery, p. 502–511.
- [20] JEANDEL, E., PERDRIX, S., AND VESHCHEREROVA, M. Addition and differentiation of zx-diagrams, May 2024.
- [21] JEANDEL, E., PERDRIX, S., AND VILMART, R. A generic normal form for zx-diagrams and application to the rational angle completeness, 2018.
- [22] LINDLEY, S., MATACHE, C., MOSS, S., STATON, S., WU, N., AND YANG, Z. Scoped effects as parameterized algebraic theories, 2024.
- [23] MCDOWALL-ROSE, H., SHAIKH, R. A., AND YEH, L. From fermions to qubits: A zx-calculus perspective, 2025.
- [24] MELLIÈS, P.-A. Functorial boxes in string diagrams. In *International Workshop on Computer Science Logic* (2006), Springer, pp. 1–30.
- [25] POÓR, B., SHAIKH, R. A., AND WANG, Q. Zx-calculus is complete for finite-dimensional hilbert spaces. *Electronic Proceedings in Theoretical Computer Science* 426 (Aug. 2025), 127–158.
- [26] POÓR, B., WANG, Q., SHAIKH, R. A., YEH, L., YEUNG, R., AND COECKE, B. Completeness for arbitrary finite dimensions of zxw-calculus, a unifying calculus. In *2023 38th Annual ACM/IEEE Symposium on Logic in Computer Science (LICS)* (June 2023), IEEE, p. 1–14.
- [27] RALL, P. Quantum algorithms for estimating physical quantities using block encodings. *Phys. Rev. A* 102 (Aug 2020), 022408.
- [28] RENNELA, M., AND STATON, S. Classical Control, Quantum Circuits and Linear Logic in Enriched Category Theory. *Logical Methods in Computer Science Volume 16, Issue 1* (Mar. 2020).
- [29] ROY, P., VAN DE WETERING, J., AND YEH, L. The qudit zh-calculus: Generalised toffoli+hadamard and universality. *Electronic Proceedings in Theoretical Computer Science* 384 (Aug. 2023), 142–170.
- [30] SATI, H., AND SCHREIBER, U. The quantum monadology. *Quantum Studies: Mathematics and Foundations* 12, 3 (Aug. 2025).
- [31] SHAIKH, R. A., WANG, Q., AND YEUNG, R. How to sum and exponentiate hamiltonians in zxw calculus. *Electronic Proceedings in Theoretical Computer Science* 394 (Nov. 2023), 236–261.
- [32] SHAIKH, R. A., YEH, L., AND GOGIOSO, S. The focked-up zx calculus: Picturing continuous-variable quantum computation, 2024.
- [33] TOUMI, A., YEUNG, R., AND DE FELICE, G. Diagrammatic differentiation for quantum machine learning. *Electronic Proceedings in Theoretical Computer Science* 343 (Sept. 2021), 132–144.
- [34] VANRIETVELDE, A., AND CHIRIBELLA, G. Universal control of quantum processes using sector-preserving channels. *Quantum Information and Computation* 21, 15 & 16 (Nov. 2021), 1320–1352.

- [35] VANRIETVELDE, A., KRISTJÁNSSON, H., AND BARRETT, J. Routed quantum circuits. *Quantum* 5 (2021), 503.
- [36] WANG, Q., EAST, R. D. P., SHAIKH, R. A., YEH, L., POÓR, B., AND COECKE, B. Beyond penrose tensor diagrams with the zx calculus: Applications to quantum computing, quantum machine learning, condensed matter physics, and quantum gravity, 2025.
- [37] WANG, Q., YEUNG, R., AND KOCH, M. Differentiating and integrating zx diagrams with applications to quantum machine learning. *Quantum* 8 (Oct. 2024), 1491.
- [38] WILSON, P., AND ZANASI, F. Reverse derivative ascent: A categorical approach to learning boolean circuits. *Electronic Proceedings in Theoretical Computer Science* 333 (Feb. 2021), 247–260.
- [39] WILSON, P., AND ZANASI, F. An axiomatic approach to differentiation of polynomial circuits. *Journal of Logical and Algebraic Methods in Programming* 135 (2023), 100892.
- [40] YEH, L. Scaling w state circuits in the qudit clifford hierarchy. In *Companion Proceedings of the 7th International Conference on the Art, Science, and Engineering of Programming* (Mar. 2023), *Programming ’23 Companion*, ACM, p. 90–100.
- [41] YEH, L., AND VAN DE WETERING, J. *Constructing All Qutrit Controlled Clifford+T gates in Clifford+T*. Springer International Publishing, 2022, p. 28–50.

Appendix A Proofs for Section 4

Proof of Proposition 2

Proof. Ctrl is sound with regards to sequential composition:

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \text{Diagram 1: A light blue box labeled 'Ctrl' containing two boxes, M_1 and M_2, connected sequentially.} \\
 & = \text{Diagram 2: Two boxes, $\tilde{M}_1$ and $\tilde{M}_2$, connected sequentially. Above $\tilde{M}_1$ is a green circle connected to the top line. Above $\tilde{M}_2$ is a green circle connected to the top line.} \\
 & = \text{Diagram 3: Two boxes, $\tilde{M}_1$ and $\tilde{M}_2$, connected sequentially. A green circle is connected to the top line and splits to connect to both $\tilde{M}_1$ and $\tilde{M}_2$.} \\
 & \stackrel{(*)}{=} \text{Diagram 4: A box labeled $\widetilde{M_2 \circ M_1}$ with a green circle connected to the top line.} \\
 & = \text{Diagram 5: A light blue box labeled 'Ctrl' containing two boxes, M_1 and M_2, connected sequentially.}
 \end{aligned} \tag{A.1}$$

Where $(*)$ follows from Proposition 1. □

Proof of Proposition 3

Proof. Consider the morphism: $\phi_{V,W} : \text{Ctrl}(V) \otimes \text{Ctrl}(W) \rightarrow \text{Ctrl}(V \otimes W)$:

$$\phi_{V,W} = \text{Diagram: A box labeled $\phi_{V,W}$ with four lines. Top two lines are labeled $\mathbb{C}^2$ and bottom two are labeled V. A green circle is on the top line. A line connects the green circle to the bottom line.} \tag{A.2}$$

By conjugating by ϕ , Ctrl is sound under parallel composition of any $M_1 : V \rightarrow V$, $M_2 : W \rightarrow W$:

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \text{Diagram 1: A light blue box labeled 'Ctrl' containing two boxes, M_1 and M_2, connected in parallel.} \\
 & = \text{Diagram 2: Two boxes, $\widetilde{M}_1$ and $\widetilde{M}_2$, connected in parallel. Above $\widetilde{M}_1$ is a green circle connected to the top line. Above $\widetilde{M}_2$ is a green circle connected to the top line.} \\
 & = \text{Diagram 3: Two boxes, $\widetilde{M}_1$ and $\widetilde{M}_2$, connected in parallel. A green circle is connected to the top line and splits to connect to both $\widetilde{M}_1$ and $\widetilde{M}_2$.} \\
 & = \text{Diagram 4: Two light blue boxes labeled 'Ctrl' containing M_1 and M_2 respectively, connected in parallel. Each box has a green circle connected to the top line.}
 \end{aligned} \tag{A.3}$$

Parallel composition is associative by associativity of the tensor product and of ϕ :

$$(A.4)$$

□

Before we prove Proposition 4, we first need to define the AND gate in the ZXW-calculus. The AND gate is a primitive in the ZH-calculus [2]. We can also represent the binary AND gate in the ZXW-calculus, by deMorgan's law of the diagram for binary OR given in Proposition 5.

Definition A.1.

$$(A.5)$$

Lemma A.1. *Short circuit:* $AND(0, x) = 0$.

$$(A.6)$$

Proof.

$$(A.7)$$

□

Lemma A.2. *Unit:* $AND(1, x) = x$.

$$(A.8)$$

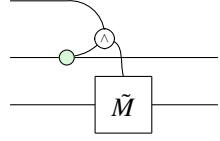
Proof.

$$(A.9)$$

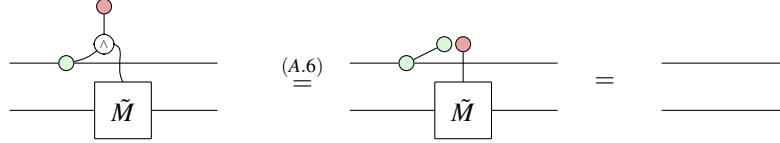
□

Proof of Proposition 4

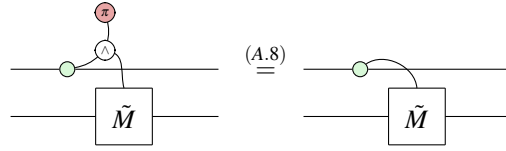
Proof. We prove this by verifying that the following diagram satisfies the conditions of being the controlled matrix on a controlled gate.


(A.10)

Verifying condition (CM0).


(A.11)

Verifying condition (CM1).


(A.12)

□

Since this is indeed the controlled matrix on a controlled gate, we obtain the required result by Equation (4.1).

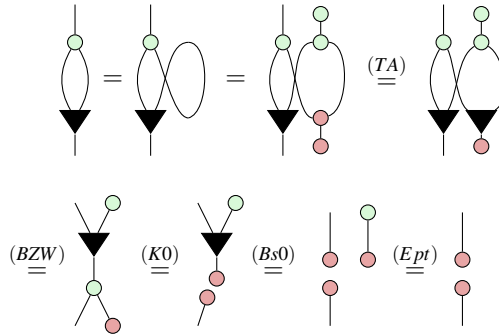
Appendix B Basic Lemmas for Arithmetic Diagrams

In this section, we prove a number of lemmas used throughout the paper.

Firstly, we can define the one-input, zero-output W node to have the same syntax and semantics as the one-input, zero-output phase-free X spider, as done for arbitrary finite dimension in [14]. In this work, all our completeness proofs for arithmetic diagrams and controlled states and operators (i.e. excluding Section C) The following proof implies that as the only place where (TA) applied is in the proof of the ZW-calculus rule (C.1), it suffices to replace (TA) by (C.1); all rules involving X spiders with two or more legs can be safely disregarded.

Proof of Lemma 6.1

Proof.



□

The remainder of this section proves a number of lemmas used throughout the paper that are all syntactic equalities, because they are derived purely through applications of the axioms of the qubit ZXW-calculus given in Figure 1.

Lemma B.1.

$$\text{Diagram: A black triangle with a red dot on its bottom-right vertex and a vertical line to its right.} = \text{Diagram: A vertical line.} \quad (\text{B.1})$$

Proof.

$$\begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram: A black triangle with a red dot on its bottom-right vertex.} \\ \xrightarrow{(C.2)} \text{Diagram: A green circle with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} \\ \xrightarrow{(K0)} \text{Diagram: A green circle with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} \\ \xrightarrow{(S2)} \text{Diagram: A green circle with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} \\ \xrightarrow{(Zer)} \text{Diagram: A green circle with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} \\ \xrightarrow{(Add)} \text{Diagram: A green circle with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} \\ \xrightarrow{(S2)} \text{Diagram: A vertical line.} \end{array} \quad \square$$

Lemma B.2.

$$\text{Diagram: A green circle with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} = \text{Diagram: A vertical line with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} \quad (\text{B.2})$$

Proof.

$$\begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram: A green circle with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} \\ = \text{Diagram: A green circle with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} \\ \xrightarrow{(Zer)} \text{Diagram: A green circle with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} \\ \xrightarrow{(K0)} \text{Diagram: A vertical line with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} \end{array} \quad \square$$

Lemma B.3.

$$\text{Diagram: A green circle with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} = \text{Diagram: A vertical line with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} \quad (\text{B.3})$$

Proof.

$$\begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram: A green circle with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} \\ = \text{Diagram: A green circle with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} \\ \xrightarrow{(BZW)} \text{Diagram: A green circle with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} \\ \xrightarrow{(Add)} \text{Diagram: A vertical line with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} \end{array} \quad \square$$

Lemma B.4.

$$\text{Diagram: A green circle with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} = \text{Diagram: A vertical line with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} \quad (\text{B.4})$$

Proof.

$$\begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram: A green circle with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} \\ = \text{Diagram: A green circle with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} \\ \xrightarrow{(B.3)} \text{Diagram: A green circle with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} \\ \xrightarrow{(B.2)} \text{Diagram: A vertical line with a red dot on its left and a black triangle on its right.} \end{array} \quad \square$$

Lemma B.5.

(B.5)

Proof.

Lemma B.6.

(B.6)

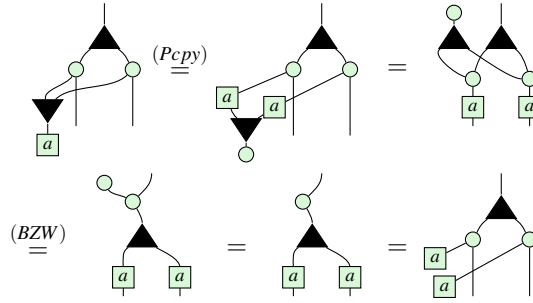
Proof.

☐

Lemma B.7.

(B.7)

Proof.

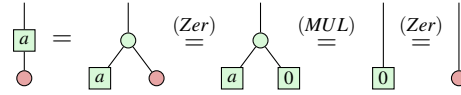


□

Lemma B.8.

$$\begin{array}{c} \text{green box } a \\ | \\ \text{red circle} \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} | \\ \text{red circle} \end{array} \quad (\text{B.8})$$

Proof.



□

Appendix C Derivation of the qubit ZXW-calculus axioms

This section derives the axioms of Figure 1, purely through syntactic equalities of axioms directly sourced from the arbitrary finite dimension setting derived in [26], with the dimension then restricted to two to recover the qubit case. This made some rules trivial and thus disregarded in this work: $(D1)$, $(H1)$, (ZV) , (VW) reduce to the same diagram on both sides of the equality, being identity. Likewise, the -1 multiplier which equals the identity in the qubit setting is omitted in the second equality of $(P1)$, here renamed to (H) to match the original rule name.

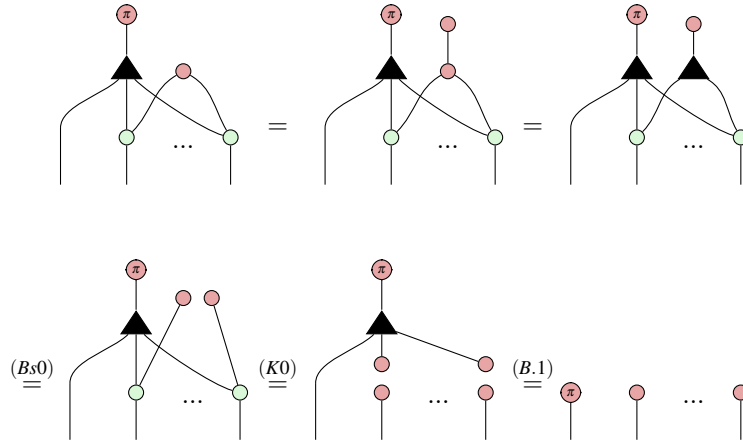
For (VA) , adopting the semantically correct interpretation that the one-output W node is the identity — which moreover syntactically agrees with [14] — makes the equation trivial in the qubit setting. Since this one-output W node appears in neither the original qudit ZXW completeness paper nor anywhere in this paper, the (VA) rule can be safely disregarded in the qubit setting.

First we prove (KZ) . This proof relies on the generalised (TA) rule from Lemmas 39 and 40 of [26], whose proof is identical in the qubit case. Note also that all multipliers on the LHS of (KZ) simplify to the identity.

Lemma C.1.

$$\begin{array}{c} \text{red circle } x \\ | \\ \text{black triangle} \\ | \quad | \quad | \quad | \\ \text{green circle} \quad \text{red circle} \quad \text{green circle} \quad \text{green circle} \\ | \quad | \quad | \quad | \\ \text{green box } a \quad \text{green box } a \quad \text{green box } a \quad \text{green box } a \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \text{red circle } x \\ | \\ \text{red circle} \\ | \\ \text{red circle} \\ | \\ \text{red circle} \end{array} \quad (\text{KZ})$$

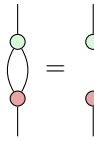
Proof.



□

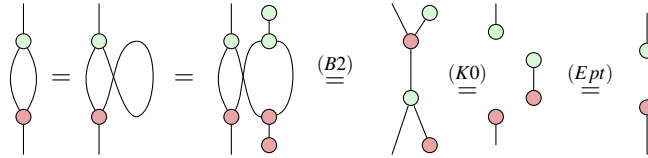
The remainder of this section is to derive (HD) from (HD) of [26], for which we first derive a number of lemmas.

Lemma C.2.



(C.1)

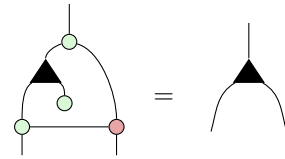
Proof.



□

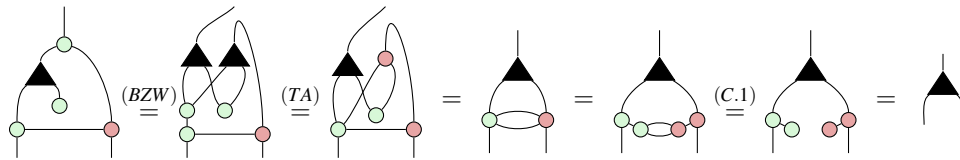
This lemma is the analogue of [26, Lemma 37] for the qubit case.

Lemma C.3.



(C.2)

Proof.



□

Next, we will prove $(Bs1)$ from the $(Bs1)$ rule of [26] restricted to the qubit setting, which is:

$$\begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \blacktriangle \\ \text{---} \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \circ \\ | \end{array} \quad (C.3)$$

Lemma C.4.

$$\begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \blacktriangle \\ \text{---} \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array} \quad (C.4)$$

Proof.

$$\begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \blacktriangle \\ \text{---} \end{array} \stackrel{(C.2)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \circ \\ \text{---} \end{array} \stackrel{(C.2)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \circ \\ \text{---} \end{array} \stackrel{(C.3)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \circ \\ \text{---} \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array}$$

□

Because we can derive the above lemma from Equation (C.3) (the $(Bs1)$ rule of [26] restricted to the qubit setting), and we can derive the latter from the former by simply applying $(K1)$, we have opted to replace the latter axiom with the former, which is simpler, in Figure 1.

Lemma C.5.

$$\begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \blacktriangle \\ \text{---} \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \circ \\ \text{---} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array} \quad (C.5)$$

Proof.

$$\begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \blacktriangle \\ \text{---} \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \circ \\ \text{---} \end{array} \stackrel{(BZW)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \circ \\ \text{---} \end{array} \stackrel{(TA)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \circ \\ \text{---} \end{array} \stackrel{(C.3)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \circ \\ \text{---} \end{array} \stackrel{(K1)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \circ \\ \text{---} \end{array} \stackrel{(C.4)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \circ \\ \text{---} \end{array} \stackrel{(C.2)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \circ \\ \text{---} \end{array}$$

□

Lemma C.6.

$$\begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \blacktriangle \\ \text{---} \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array} \quad (C.6)$$

Proof.

$$\begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \blacktriangle \\ \text{---} \end{array} \stackrel{(C.2)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \circ \\ \text{---} \end{array} \stackrel{(K0)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \circ \\ \text{---} \end{array} \stackrel{(C.5)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \circ \\ \text{---} \end{array} \stackrel{(Bs0)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \circ \\ \text{---} \end{array} \stackrel{(Ept)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \circ \\ \text{---} \end{array} \stackrel{(K0)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \pi \\ \text{---} \end{array}$$

□

Lemma C.7.

(C.7)

Proof.

□

Lemma C.8.

(C.8)

Proof.

□

Lemma C.9.

(C.9)

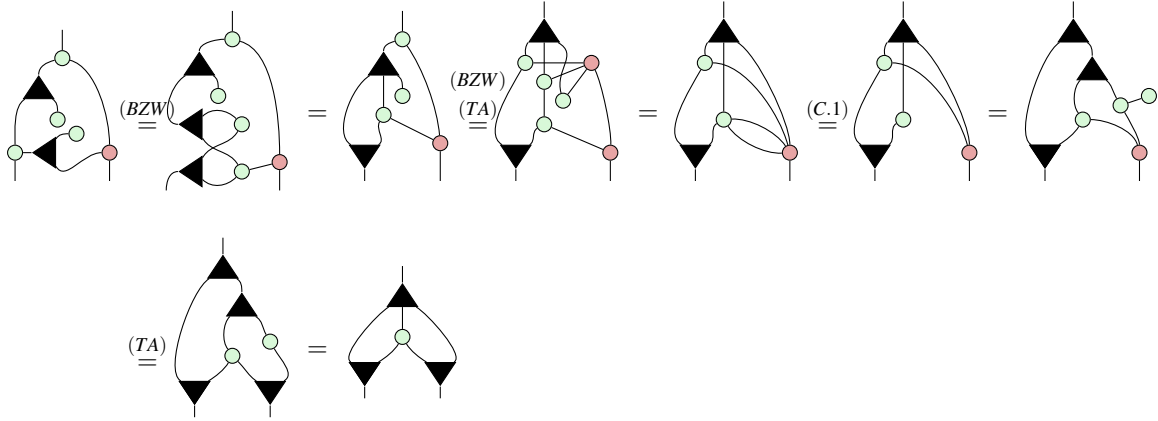
Proof.

□

Lemma C.10.

(C.10)

Proof.



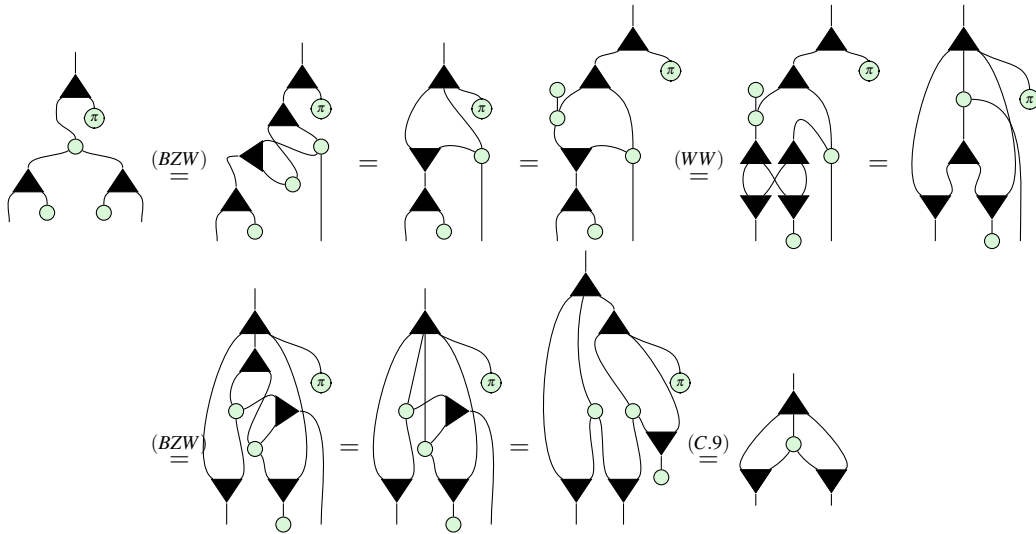
□

Lemma C.11.



(C.11)

Proof.



□

Finally, we derive the axiom (HD) .

Proposition 6.

$$= \text{Diagram 1} = \text{Diagram 2} = \text{Diagram 3} \quad (\text{C.12})$$

where the middle of the three diagrams is the result of restricting the (HD) axiom from [26] for arbitrary finite dimension, to the qubit (two-dimensional) setting.

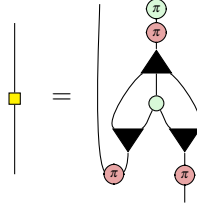
Proof.

$$\begin{aligned} &= \text{Diagram 1} = \text{Diagram 2} = \text{Diagram 3} \quad (\text{K1}) \\ &= \text{Diagram 4} \quad (\text{C.5}) \\ &= \text{Diagram 5} \quad (\text{K2}) \\ &= \text{Diagram 6} \quad (\text{C.10}) \\ &= \text{Diagram 7} \quad (\text{C.11}) \\ &= \text{Diagram 8} \quad (\text{Pcpy}) \\ &= \text{Diagram 9} \quad (\text{K2}) \\ &= \text{Diagram 10} \quad (\text{C.5}) \\ &= \text{Diagram 11} \quad (\text{K1}) \\ &= \text{Diagram 12} \quad (\text{Add}) \\ &= \text{Diagram 13} = \text{Diagram 14} = \text{Diagram 15} \end{aligned}$$

□

Remark 8. As a useful observation, compare the following diagram for the Hadamard gate derived above, to the

diagram for the AND gate from Definition A.1.



This precisely agrees with its action applying a -1 phase determined by the AND of the input and output bit.

Appendix D Proofs for Section 5

D.1 Rules for controlled diagrams

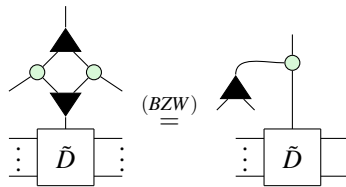
In this subsection, we verify the soundness of the axioms for controlled diagrams with respect to the interpretations.

The soundness of axioms *CM0*, *CM1*, *CS0*, and *CS1* with respect to the interpretations in Equations (3.1) and (3.2), immediately follows from applying the control states $\begin{bmatrix} \text{red circle} \\ | \end{bmatrix} = |0\rangle$ and $\begin{bmatrix} \text{red circle with pi} \\ | \end{bmatrix} = |1\rangle$ respectively.

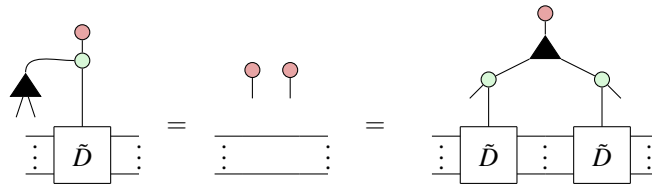
For the remaining axioms, we will also prove soundness through verifying the actions of controlled diagrams on the control states $|0\rangle$ and $|1\rangle$. This is a common technique which uniquely fixes the interpretation because $|0\rangle$ and $|1\rangle$ form a basis for the control qubit, and thus any single-qubit state can be uniquely written as a linear combination of these two states.

Confirmation of (CMc_{py})

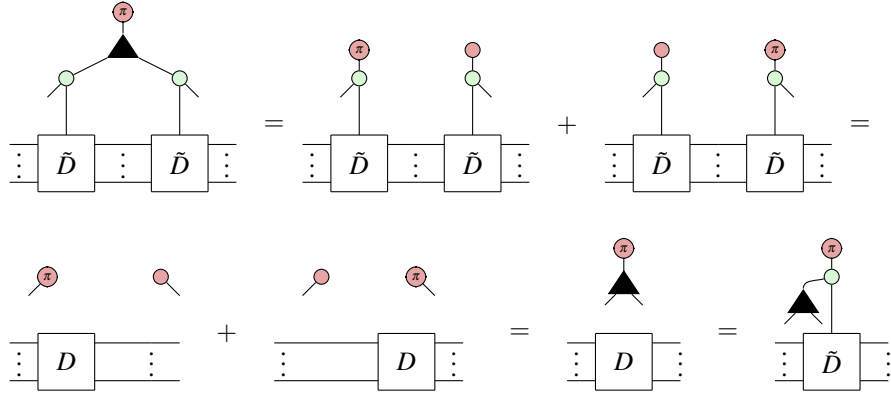
First of all, using (BZW) we can rewrite the LHS to



Then clearly



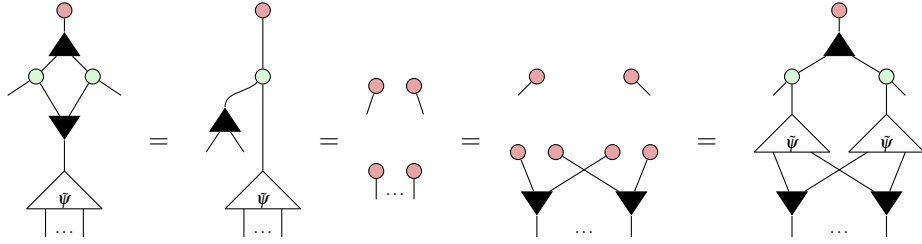
Meanwhile,



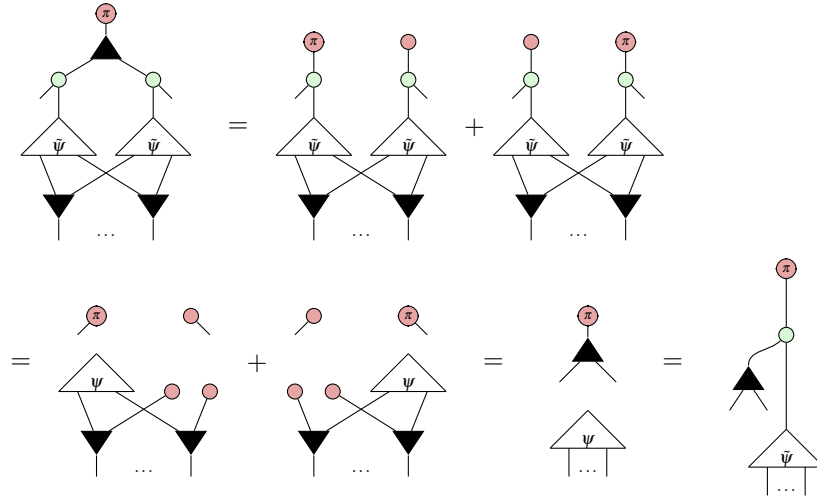
Thus the two sides are equal over the Z basis and so are equal as diagrams.

Confirmation of CS_{copy}

As before, plugging $|0\rangle$ gives

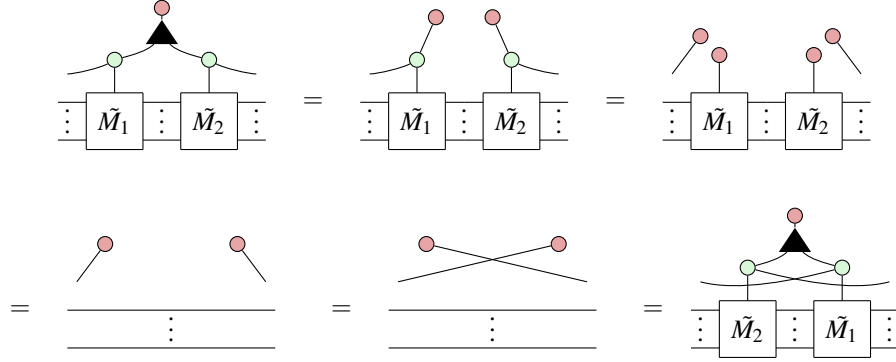


Meanwhile, plugging $|1\rangle$ gives

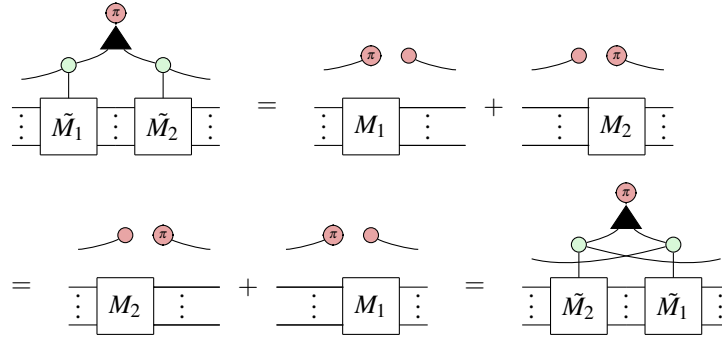


Confirmation of CMcom

Plugging $|0\rangle$ of course gives



Meanwhile, plugging $|1\rangle$ we have

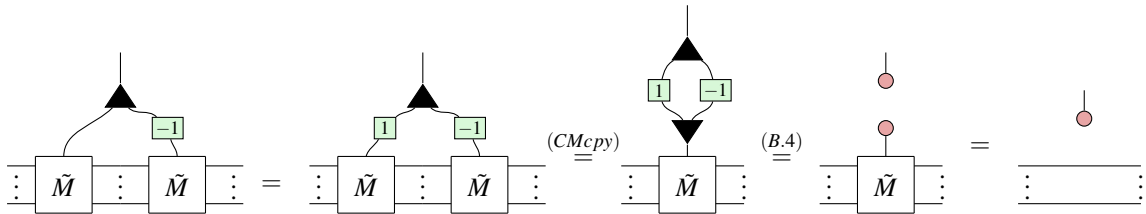


D.2 Proofs for Ring Properties

Now we prove the remaining ring properties using purely diagrammatic rewrites.

Proof of Lemma 5.2

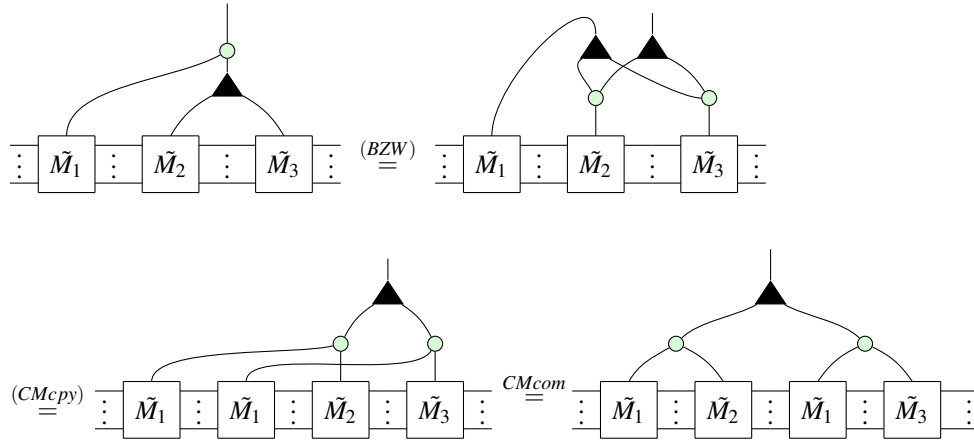
Proof.



□

Proof of Lemma 5.3

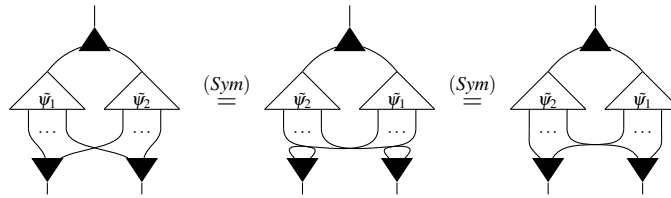
Proof.



□

Proof of Lemma 5.4

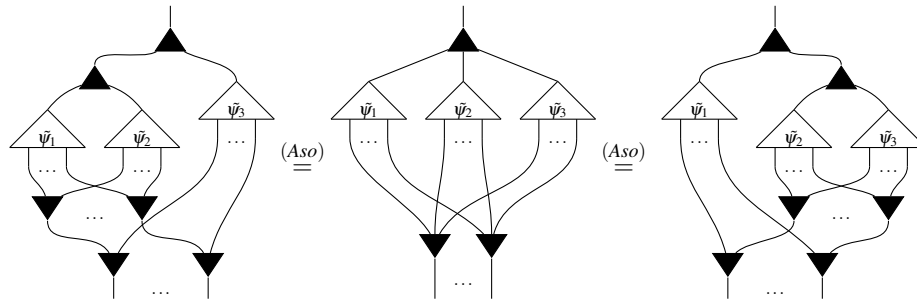
Proof.



□

Proof of Lemma 5.5

Proof.

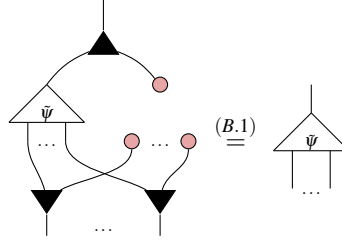


□

Proof of Lemma 5.6

Proof. It is clear that  is the controlled state $\tilde{0}$.

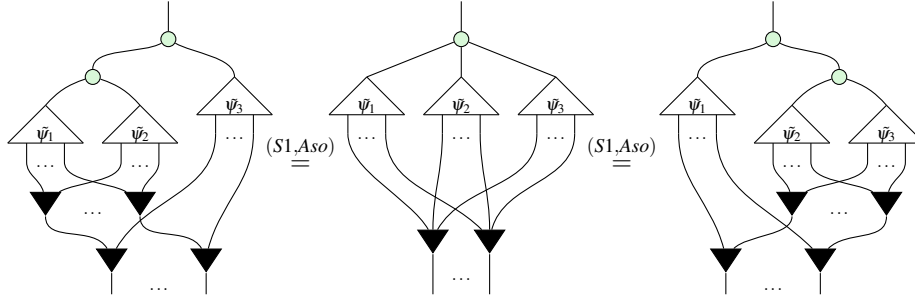
Then we have:



□

Proof of Lemma 5.8

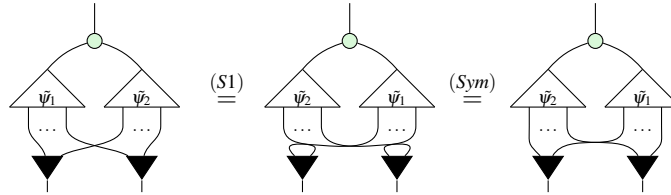
Proof. Proof is very similar to lemma 5.5, just using with (S1) instead of (Aso)



□

Proof of Lemma 5.9

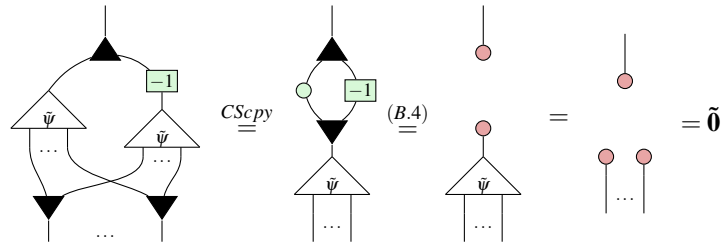
Proof.



□

Proof of Lemma 5.7

Proof. $\tilde{\psi}^{-1}$ is still a controlled state since $\boxed{-1}$ does nothing to $\mid \cdot \rangle$. Then $\tilde{\psi}^{-1}$ inverts $\tilde{\psi}$ since:



□

Proof of Lemma 5.10

Proof.

$$\begin{aligned}
 \tilde{\psi}_1 \boxtimes (\tilde{\psi}_2 \boxplus \tilde{\psi}_3) &= \text{Diagram 1} \stackrel{(BZW)}{=} \text{Diagram 2} \\
 &= \text{Diagram 3} \stackrel{(CScpy)}{=} \text{Diagram 4} \\
 &= \text{Diagram 5} = \text{Diagram 6} \\
 &= (\tilde{\psi}_1 \boxtimes \tilde{\psi}_2) \boxplus (\tilde{\psi}_1 \boxtimes \tilde{\psi}_3)
 \end{aligned}$$

□

Appendix E Proofs for Section 6

Proof of Proposition 5

Proof. We prove by induction on n .

For the base case, $n = 0$. The only PNF with no outputs is a number so we have:

$$\boxed{a_0} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & a_0 \end{bmatrix}$$

as desired.

For inductive hypothesis, we assume that Proposition 5 holds for every PNF on n outputs. We use this hypothesis to extend it to PNFs with $n + 1$ outputs.

Next, plugging red we observe:

[illegible]

Meanwhile,

Figure 1: Diagrammatic representation of the K_0 operator. The figure shows a sequence of five diagrams. The first diagram shows a box labeled D with an incoming line from the top and an outgoing line to a red circle labeled π . The second diagram shows D split into D_{even} and D_{odd} , with a green circle on the line from D_{odd} to the π circle. The third diagram shows the same split, but with two red circles labeled π on the line from D_{odd} . The fourth diagram shows the same split, but with two red circles labeled π on the line from D_{even} . The fifth diagram shows the same split, but with two red circles labeled π on the line from D_{odd} . The diagrams are connected by equals signs and labeled (C.6), (6.5), and (B.1).

Summing these together,

$$\begin{array}{c} \text{---} \\ | \\ \boxed{D} \\ | \\ \dots \\ | \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \text{---} \\ | \\ \boxed{D} \\ | \\ \dots \\ | \end{array} + \begin{array}{c} \text{---} \\ | \\ \boxed{D} \\ | \\ \dots \\ | \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \text{---} \\ | \\ \boxed{D_{\text{even}}} \\ | \\ \dots \\ | \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \circ \\ | \end{array} + \begin{array}{c} \text{---} \\ | \\ \boxed{D_{\text{odd}}} \\ | \\ \dots \\ | \end{array} \begin{array}{c} \circ \\ | \end{array} \quad (\text{E.7})$$

$$= (D_{even} \otimes |0\rangle) + (D_{odd} |1\rangle \langle 1| \otimes |1\rangle) \quad (\text{E.8})$$

$$\stackrel{(*)}{=} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & a_0 \\ 0 & a_2 \\ \vdots & \vdots \\ 0 & a_{2^{n+1}-2} \end{bmatrix} \otimes |0\rangle + \begin{bmatrix} 0 & a_1 \\ 0 & a_3 \\ \vdots & \vdots \\ 0 & a_{2^{n+1}-1} \end{bmatrix} \otimes |1\rangle \quad (\text{E.9})$$

$$= \begin{bmatrix} 1 & a_0 \\ 0 & 0 \\ 0 & a_2 \\ 0 & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots \\ 0 & a_{2^{n+1}-2} \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} + \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & a_1 \\ 0 & 0 \\ 0 & a_3 \\ \vdots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 \\ 0 & a_{2^{n+1}-1} \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & a_0 \\ 0 & a_1 \\ 0 & a_2 \\ 0 & a_3 \\ \vdots & \vdots \\ 0 & a_{2^{n+1}-2} \\ 0 & a_{2^{n+1}-1} \end{bmatrix} \quad (\text{E.10})$$

Completing the inductive step. Note that it is necessary to use a "proof-by-plugging" approach for this result, since we are proving a statement about the interpretation of a ZXW diagram as a matrix, whilst the completeness of our rule set applies only to equality of ZXW diagrams. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 6.1

Proof. Let A be an arithmetic diagram. If $A = \boxed{a}$, we are done.

Otherwise, A has at least one output. First, we shall rewrite A into three layers, consisting of: (1) a single W at the top, (2) a layer of $\circlearrowleft$ and (3) a layer of $\boxed{a}$'s and $\blacktriangledown$'s. Then we shall collect terms and order the boxes to produce a PNF.

If the top of A is not already $\blacktriangle$, it must be $\circlearrowleft$. It cannot be $\boxed{a}$ since the remaining arithmetic diagram would then have no inputs which is impossible. It cannot be $\blacktriangledown$ since there is only one input and arithmetic diagrams cannot contain $\cap$. Thus we can rewrite:

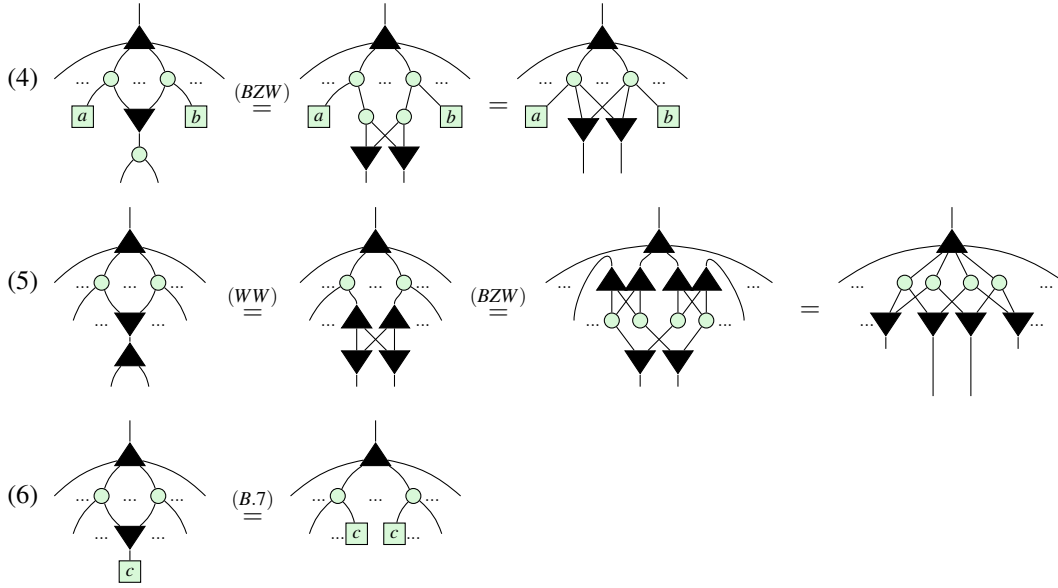
$$(1) \quad \circlearrowleft \stackrel{(B.1)}{=} \boxed{0} \blacktriangle \circlearrowleft$$

(1) guarantees there is a W at the top. We shall now repeatedly apply rewrites underneath the W until there are exactly three layers. Assume that fusion is applied as much as possible between each stage and (6.4) is applied

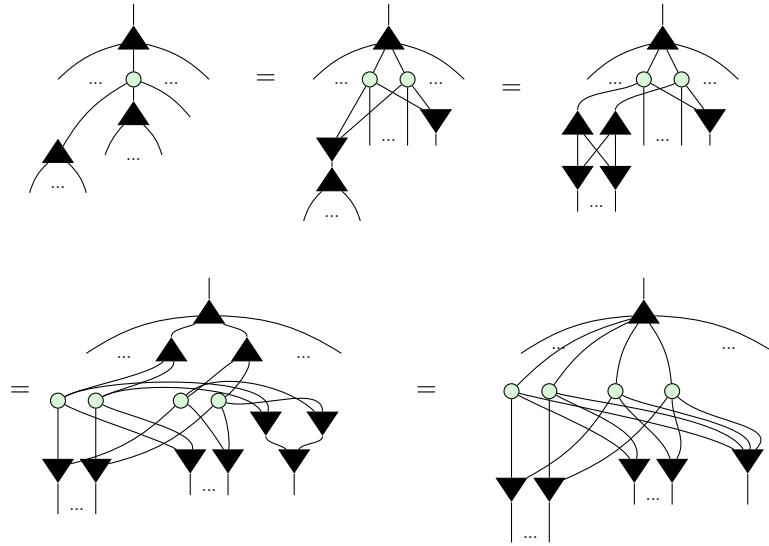
and simplified with (K0) to remove $\circlearrowleft \blacktriangledown$ whenever possible. Then for as long as there are at least 4 layers, we can apply one of the following rewrites:

$$(2) \quad \begin{array}{c} \blacktriangle \\ \cap \\ \blacktriangledown \end{array} \stackrel{(B.3)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \blacktriangle \\ \boxed{2} \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \blacktriangle \\ \circlearrowleft \\ \boxed{2} \end{array}$$

$$(3) \quad \begin{array}{c} \blacktriangle \\ \cap \\ \circlearrowleft \\ \blacktriangle \end{array} \stackrel{(BZW)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \blacktriangle \\ \cap \\ \blacktriangle \\ \cap \\ \circlearrowleft \\ \blacktriangle \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \blacktriangle \\ \cap \\ \circlearrowleft \\ \cap \\ \blacktriangle \end{array}$$



Clearly, we can only stop applying these rules once A is a sum of products of copies. Steps (2) and (3) ensure the top of A has such a structure and steps (4) - (6) ensure that there is nothing beneath the $\blacktriangledown$'s. To see that this will always terminate, observe that (2) preserves the depth of A while (4), (5), (6) all decrease it. (3) also preserves the depth, except for the following sub-case which can be further simplified by (5) ¹.



(2) and (3) can only be applied a finite number of times before another simplification must be used, since (2) cannot create new ways to apply (3). So repeatedly applying these rewrites must eventually shrink the depth down to 3, as desired. Finally, to put A in PNF we must:

(7) Collect terms: whenever there are two boxes connected to exactly the same set of $\blacktriangledown$'s, use (B.5) to fuse them together.

(8) Pad: use (B.2) to insert $\boxed{0}$ for any connectivities that do not exist in A .

¹We thank an anonymous reviewer for pointing this case out.

(9) Reorder: use (Sym) to reorder coefficients into the canonical order.

Step (7) ensures that every  has unique connectivity. Step (8) ensures there are exactly 2^n coefficients so that step (9) can order them in the appropriate way.

Thus A has been written in PNF, completing the proof. □

Proof of Theorem 6.2

Proof. First, we show ϕ_n is a homomorphism, i.e.

$$\forall p, q \in \mathcal{P}_n, \phi_n(p+q) = \phi_n(p) \boxplus \phi_n(q), \quad \phi_n(p \times q) = \phi_n(p) \boxtimes \phi_n(q) \quad (\text{E.11})$$

The strategy for the proof will be an induction on n . Here, the yellow shaded regions serve no purpose other than to make the subdiagram that was rewritten in the preceding or following step easier to visually identify.

Base case: We have not defined controlled states for $n = 0$, so the base case begins with $n = 1$. Let $p, q \in \mathcal{P}_1$. Write as $p(x_1) = a_0 + a_1x_1, q(x_1) = b_0 + b_1x_1$, where $a_0, a_1, b_0, b_1 \in \mathbb{C}$. Then since $p+q = a_0 + b_0 + (a_1 + b_1)x_1$,

$$\begin{aligned} \phi_1(p) \boxplus \phi_1(q) &= \begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram 1: A node with two inputs and two outputs. The left input is labeled } \bar{p} \text{ and the right input is labeled } \bar{q}. \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram 2: A node with four inputs labeled } a_0, a_1, b_0, b_1. \text{ The inputs } a_0, a_1 \text{ are grouped by a yellow shaded region, and } b_0, b_1 \text{ are grouped by another yellow shaded region.} \end{array} \\ &= \begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram 3: A node with four inputs labeled } a_0, a_1, b_0, b_1. \text{ The inputs } a_0, b_0 \text{ are grouped by a yellow shaded region, and } a_1, b_1 \text{ are grouped by another yellow shaded region.} \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram 4: A node with four inputs labeled } a_0, b_0, a_1, b_1. \end{array} \\ &\stackrel{(B.3)}{=} \begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram 5: A node with two inputs labeled } a_0+b_0 \text{ and } a_1+b_1. \text{ The inputs are grouped by a yellow shaded region.} \end{array} = \begin{array}{c} \text{Diagram 6: A node with one input labeled } \bar{p+q}. \end{array} = \phi_1(p+q) \quad (\text{E.12}) \end{aligned}$$

Meanwhile, since $p \times q = a_0b_0 + (a_0b_1 + a_1b_0)x_1$,

$$\begin{aligned}
 \phi_1(p) \boxtimes \phi_1(q) &= \text{Diagram 1} = \text{Diagram 2} \stackrel{(B.6)}{=} \text{Diagram 3} \\
 &\stackrel{(B.7)}{=} \text{Diagram 4} \stackrel{(Pcpy)}{=} \text{Diagram 5} \stackrel{(6.4)}{=} \text{Diagram 6} \\
 &\stackrel{(B.8)}{=} \text{Diagram 7} \stackrel{(B.3)}{=} \text{Diagram 8} = \text{Diagram 9} = \phi_1(p \times q)
 \end{aligned} \tag{E.13}$$

The diagrams represent string diagrams for the proof. Diagram 1 shows two separate loops for $\phi_1(p)$ and $\phi_1(q)$. Diagram 2 introduces variables a_0, a_1, b_0, b_1 . Diagram 3 is a more complex network of nodes and edges. Diagram 4 uses the (B.7) rule. Diagram 5 uses the (Pcpy) rule. Diagram 6 uses the (6.4) rule. Diagram 7 uses the (B.8) rule. Diagram 8 uses the (B.3) rule. Diagram 9 is the final result $\phi_1(p \times q)$.

Completing the base case.

Inductive step:

Let $Hom(n)$ assert that ϕ_n is a homomorphism. Then for the inductive step we wish to prove that $\forall n, Hom(n) \implies Hom(n+1)$.

The proof relies on the recursive definition of $R[x_1, x_2] = R[x_1][x_2]$, for any ring R , to rewrite an arbitrary polynomial $p(x_1, \dots, x_{n+1}) = a_0 + a_1x_{n+1} + \dots + a_{2^{n+1}-1}x_1x_2\dots x_{n+1} \in \mathcal{P}_{n+1}$ as $p(x_{n+1}) = p_0 + p_1x_{n+1}$, where $p_0, p_1 \in \mathcal{P}_n$. This allows the p_i to be treated similarly to the scalars in the base case. Thus the inductive hypothesis states that for all $p_i, q_i \in \mathcal{P}_n$,

$$\phi_n(p_i) \boxplus \phi_n(q_i) = \text{Diagram 1} = \text{Diagram 2} = \phi_n(p_i + q_i) \tag{IH1}$$

Diagram 1 shows two separate loops for $\phi_n(p_i)$ and $\phi_n(q_i)$. Diagram 2 shows a single loop for $\phi_n(p_i + q_i)$.

$$\phi_n(p_i) \boxtimes \phi_n(q_i) = \text{Diagram 1} = \text{Diagram 2} = \phi_n(p_i \times q_i) \tag{IH2}$$

Diagram 1 shows two separate loops for $\phi_n(p_i)$ and $\phi_n(q_i)$. Diagram 2 shows a single loop for $\phi_n(p_i \times q_i)$.

Let $p(x_{n+1}) = p_0 + p_1x_{n+1}$ and $q(x_{n+1}) = q_0 + q_1x_{n+1}$, where $p_0, p_1, q_0, q_1 \in \mathcal{P}_n$. We first verify correctness

Applying this in the inductive step for constructing a controlled diagram of $p+q$ from those of p and q :

$$\begin{aligned}
 \phi_{n+1}(p) \boxplus \phi_{n+1}(q) &= \text{Diagram 1} = \text{Diagram 2} \\
 &= \text{Diagram 3} = \text{Diagram 4} \\
 &= \text{Diagram 5} \stackrel{(BZW)}{=} \text{Diagram 6} \\
 &\stackrel{(IH1)}{=} \text{Diagram 7} = \phi_{n+1}((p_0+q_0) + (p_1+q_1)x_{n+1})) = \phi_{n+1}(p+q)
 \end{aligned}$$

The diagrams illustrate the construction of a controlled diagram for $p+q$ from those of p and q . The diagrams are composed of nodes (black triangles) and edges (curved lines). The inputs are labeled $x_1, \dots, x_n, x_{n+1}$. The nodes are labeled with $\bar{p}_0, \bar{p}_1, \dots, \bar{q}_0, \bar{q}_1, \dots$. The diagram 2 shows a more complex structure with additional nodes and edges, including a green circle. The diagram 3 shows a further simplification. The diagram 4 shows a more complex structure with additional nodes and edges, including a green circle. The diagram 5 shows a further simplification. The diagram 6 shows a more complex structure with additional nodes and edges, including a green circle. The diagram 7 shows a further simplification, where the nodes are labeled $\bar{p}_0+q_0, \bar{p}_1+q_1, \dots$.

Similarly, for multiplication:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \phi_{n+1}(p) \boxtimes \phi_{n+1}(q) &= \text{Diagram 1} = \text{Diagram 2} \\
 &\stackrel{(B.6)}{=} \text{Diagram 3} \stackrel{(BZW)}{=} \text{Diagram 4} \\
 &= \text{Diagram 5} \stackrel{(CScpy)}{=} \text{Diagram 6} \\
 &= \text{Diagram 7} \stackrel{(IH2),(6.4)}{=} \text{Diagram 8} \\
 &= \text{Diagram 9} \stackrel{(CS0)}{=} \text{Diagram 10} \\
 &= \phi_{n+1}((p_0 \times q_0) + (q_0 \times p_1)x_{n+1} + (p_0 \times q_1)x_{n+1}) = \phi_{n+1}(p \times q)
 \end{aligned}$$

The diagrams illustrate the proof of the distributive law for multiplication in the rewriting theory of string diagrams. The proof proceeds through several steps, each corresponding to a specific rewriting rule or identity:

- Diagram 1:** The initial expression $\phi_{n+1}(p) \boxtimes \phi_{n+1}(q)$ is represented by a string diagram with two main components, p and q , each having its own set of inputs and outputs.
- Diagram 2:** The first transformation, labeled $(B.6)$, introduces a new layer of nodes (green circles) and connects them to the existing structure.
- Diagram 3:** The second transformation, labeled (BZW) , further modifies the connections between the nodes, introducing a new layer of nodes (black triangles).
- Diagram 4:** The third transformation, labeled $(CScpy)$, involves a more complex rearrangement of the nodes and their connections.
- Diagram 5:** The fourth transformation, labeled $(IH2),(6.4)$, introduces a new layer of nodes (red circles) and connects them to the existing structure.
- Diagram 6:** The fifth transformation, labeled $(CS0)$, involves a final rearrangement of the nodes and their connections.
- Diagram 7:** The final result of the proof, showing the expression $\phi_{n+1}((p_0 \times q_0) + (q_0 \times p_1)x_{n+1} + (p_0 \times q_1)x_{n+1})$.
- Diagram 8:** The final result of the proof, showing the expression $\phi_{n+1}(p \times q)$.

This completes the inductive step, proving that $\forall n > 1$, ϕ_n is a homomorphism.

Finally, to see ϕ_n is an isomorphism, we use Theorem 6.1 to write an arbitrary controlled state in PNF:

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & a_0 \\ 0 & a_1 \\ \vdots & \vdots \\ 0 & a_{2^n-1} \end{bmatrix} = \text{Diagram}$$

Then all we have to do is interpret it as the image of a polynomial:

$$\begin{aligned} & \text{Diagram} = \text{Diagram} \\ &= \phi_n(a_0) + \phi_n(a_1 x_n) + \dots + \phi_n(a_{2^n-1} x_1 x_2 \dots x_n) \\ &= \phi_n(a_0 + a_1 x_n + \dots + a_{2^n-1} x_1 x_2 \dots x_n) \end{aligned}$$

□